



A COMMUNITY OF CHOICE

Planning and Development Department

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MEMO

To: Honorable Mayor Patrick Collins and Members of the City Council
From: Connor White, Planner II
Subject: Belvoir Ranch Master Plan Update 2024
Date: April 28, 2025

Background:

The item for consideration is to certify the Belvoir Ranch Master Plan Update 2024. On April 21, 2024, the Planning Commission held a public hearing, accepted public comments and adopted the Master Plan.

The proposed Governing Body review schedule is as follows:

- Introduction and referral April 28, 2025
- Public Services Committee May 5, 2025
- Final consideration May 12, 2025

The purpose of this update is to recognize the existing conditions of the Ranch, changes to the property since the 2008 Master Plan, and to set a framework for considering new uses at the Belvoir Ranch. The Plan update was crafted through significant stakeholder interaction in the form of public meetings and focus group discussions. This update does not go in depth regarding existing conditions and the history of the Ranch but rather presents an implementation blueprint for considering newly proposed uses at the Belvoir. A complete history of the Ranch can be found in the 2008 Master Plan as the historical information has not significantly changed. Furthermore, the 2008 Master Plan contains an extensive analysis of the natural and anthropological history of the Ranch.

Enclosed:
Resolution
Belvoir Ranch Master Plan Update 2024

RESOLUTION NO. _____

ENTITLED: “A RESOLUTION CERTIFYING AND ADOPTING THE BELVOIR RANCH MASTER PLAN.”

WHEREAS, Wyoming Statute § 15-1-503 allows each incorporated municipality to adopt a master plan for the physical development of the municipality;

WHEREAS, by Resolution No. 5069, dated September 8, 2008, the Governing Body of the City of Cheyenne adopted the 2008 Belvoir Ranch Master Plan ("2008 Master Plan");

WHEREAS, an update to the 2008 Master Plan is necessary to reflect existing conditions, funding considerations, and the changing needs of the community;

WHEREAS, the City of Cheyenne retained AVI, PC to update the 2008 Master Plan;

WHEREAS, the plan update identifies potential land uses, discusses a community vision for the property, describes a management framework for the Ranch, establishes a decision-making framework of policies to aid in future decisions, and discusses implementation, financing, and management strategies for the property;

WHEREAS, to gather important feedback on relevant issues, concerns, and recommendations regarding the Belvoir Ranch plan update, the City solicited public comment that consisted of stakeholder meetings, two public meetings on May 30, 2024, and June 12, 2024, and two City Council Work Sessions on June 28, 2024, and April 11, 2025;

WHEREAS, on April 21, 2025, the City of Cheyenne Planning Commission held a public hearing, accepted public comments, and adopted Resolution 25-01 approving the 2024 Master Plan; and

WHEREAS, a copy of the "Belvoir Ranch Master Plan 2024" ("2024 Master Plan") is attached to this Resolution as Exhibit "A".

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE, WYOMING, that the City of Cheyenne Governing Body hereby certifies and adopts the “Belvoir Ranch Master Plan 2024”;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the “Belvoir Ranch Master Plan 2024” shall amend and supplement the 2008 Belvoir Ranch Master Plan; and

BE IT FINALLY RESOLVED, that the “Belvoir Ranch Master Plan 2024” shall be used to guide the City of Cheyenne’s future development of the Belvoir Ranch, Big Hole, and Mariah Pasture.

PRESENTED, READ, AND ADOPTED THIS _____ DAY OF _____, 2025.

Patrick Collins, Mayor

(Seal)

ATTEST:

Kylie Soden, City Clerk



CITY OF CHEYENNE

Belvoir Ranch Master Plan

2024 UPDATE

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

THIS PROJECT COULD NOT HAVE BEEN
COMPLETED WITHOUT THE HELP OF:

PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT

CITY ENGINEER

BOARD OF PUBLIC UTILITIES

PUBLIC WORKS

GRANTS MANAGER

CHEYENNE CITY COUNCIL

PUBLIC MEETING ATTENDEES

RESIDENTS OF HARRIMAN ROAD

LARIMER COUNTY OPEN SPACE

FORT COLLINS NATURAL AREAS

PRODUCED BY

AVI PC



CONTENTS

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION	4
CHAPTER 2: EXISTING CONDITIONS	10
CHAPTER 3: COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT	24
CHAPTER 4: CHARACTER AREAS	40
CHAPTER 5: 2008 IMPLEMENTATION	52
CHAPTER 6: IMPLEMENTATION	52

CHAPTER

01

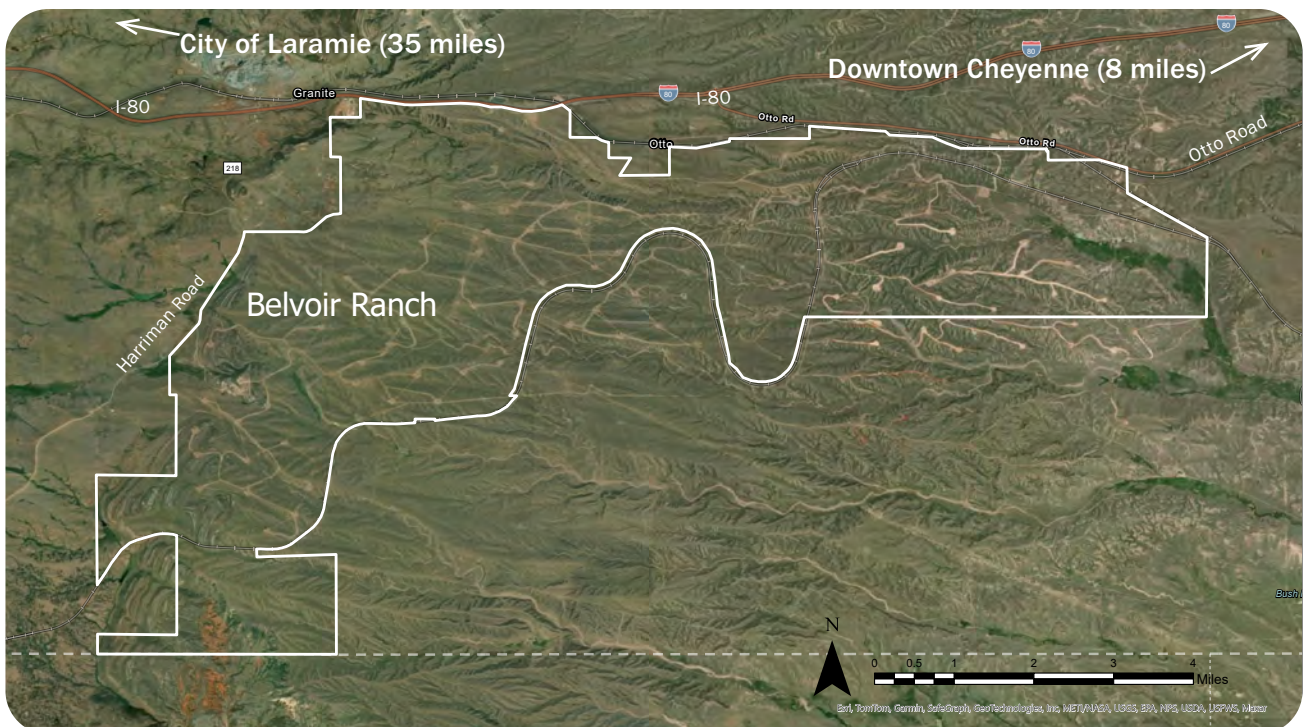
Introduction



INTRODUCTION

The Belvoir Ranch and Big Hole Properties are a significant asset for the City of Cheyenne. The Ranch is located approximately eight (8) miles west of Downtown Cheyenne and continues to Harriman Road roughly between Interstate 80 and the Colorado border. The general location of the Belvoir Ranch can be seen below. The property was purchased in 2003 to be used for water development for the Board of Public Utilities and as a site for a landfill for the City of Cheyenne Public Works Department. The ranch includes approximately six (6) sections of state land on which the City is the primary leaseholder. In addition to the Ranch purchase of 2003, the City worked with the Nature Conservancy to acquire the Big Hole property. An initial Master Plan was created for the property in 2008 (including the State sections and the Big Hole); however, many items considered in the plan have not come to fruition. In recent years, significant capital has been poured into the property with the construction of over 100 wind turbines. The City also acquired the Mariah Pasture in 2019 adding an additional 550 acres to the Ranch in the far southwest corner. Furthermore, the Ranch has seen significant interest from a variety of other uses ranging from a variety of renewable energy alternatives to data center development. These new uses coupled with the implementation of trails illustrate a clear impetus for the update of the Ranch Master Plan. The Metropolitan Planning Organization (MPO) has also added the Belvoir Ranch to its planning area.

In March of 2024 the City of Cheyenne contracted with AVI PC to do a targeted update of the 2008 Belvoir Ranch and Big Hole Master Plan. The purpose of this update is to recognize the existing conditions of the Ranch, changes to the property since the 2008 Master Plan, and to set a framework for considering new uses at the Belvoir Ranch. The Plan update was crafted through significant stakeholder interaction in the form of public meetings and focus group discussions. These conversations helped prioritize the uses, goals, and policies discussed in Chapters 4 and 6. This update does not go in depth regarding existing conditions and the history of the Ranch, but rather presents an implementation blueprint for considering newly proposed uses at the Belvoir. A complete history of the Ranch can be found in the 2008 Master Plan as the historical information has not significantly changed. Furthermore, the 2008 Master Plan contains an extensive analysis of the natural and anthropological history of the Ranch.



INTRODUCTION TO THE RANCH



The City of Cheyenne purchased the Belvoir Ranch in 2003 for the purposes of developing a new landfill and acquiring rights to the water wells located at the property. The funds used to acquire the Ranch were a combination of funds from the Board of Public Utilities and the City Public Works Department, both of which maintain a vested interest in the Ranch for these purchase reasons. The City expanded the

size of the Ranch with the acquisition of the Big Hole property that borders Colorado. The purchase of this property was facilitated by the Nature Conservancy, which holds a conservation easement on it. The Big Hole connects to Larimer County's Red Mountain Open Space which further connects to the City of Fort Collins's Soapstone Prairie Natural Area.

Altogether, the Belvoir Ranch and Big Hole total nearly 20,000 acres, including the 4,000 acres of State-owned land on which the City is considered a lease-holder. The Ranch has always been seen as an opportunity for use by the City of Cheyenne, its residents, and other potential development.

- FAST FACTS**
- » **Belvoir Ranch purchased 2003**
 - » **Big Hole purchased 2005**
 - » **Mariah Pasture purchased 2019**
 - » **Master plan 2008**
 - » **19,032 Acres (Over 20,000 with State Lands)**
 - » **3 rail lines divide the Ranch inhibiting access**
 - » **Shares border with Colorado open spaces**

TIMELINE OF CITY INVOLVEMENT

2003

Belvoir Ranch Purchase

The City purchased the Belvoir Ranch in 2003 with the intent of a number of uses; including water development, a landfill site, energy development, and recreation. The funds used for the purchase were a combination of funds from Public Works and the Board of Public Utilities.

2005

Big Hole Purchase

Two years later, the City bought the adjacent Big Hole property from the Nature Conservancy. The Big Hole added approximately 1,800 acres to the Ranch and is often included in ranch planning.

2008

Belvoir Ranch Plan

In 2008, the City adopted the Belvoir Ranch Master Plan to guide future development of the property. The plan includes a mix of uses for the Belvoir, including a number of trailheads, trails, and connections to the adjacent Red Mountain Open Space in Colorado.

2019

Mariah Pasture Acquisition

The City of Cheyenne cooperated with Dyno Nobel to acquire the Mariah Pasture and conduct a land swap for the property. The Mariah Pasture provides additional hiking and fishing opportunities.

2020

NextEra Wind Project

The Roundhouse Wind Energy Center is a two-phase wind energy project located on and near the Belvoir Ranch. The first phase of the project began operations in June 2020. The project contains 106 wind turbines.

2022

City Council Priority

On January 15th, 2022, the City of Cheyenne Governing Body met for a goal setting session to discuss their main objectives for 2022. Included in this was a goal for public access on the property and get "boots and bikes on the ground".

2024

Planning and Grants

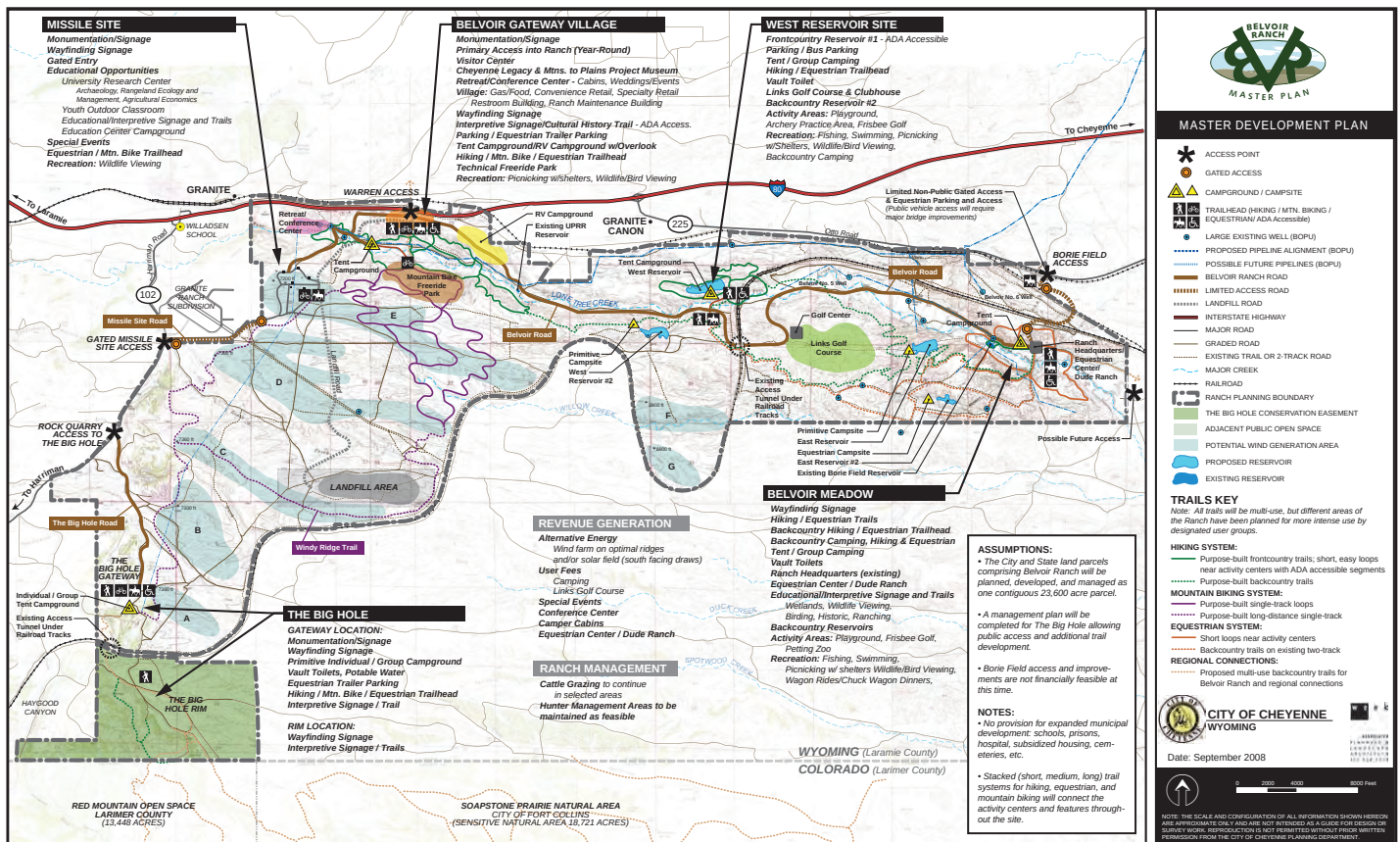
In January 2024, the City received a \$486,000 grant from the Wyoming Office of Outdoor Recreation to construct a trailhead and initial trail. Construction began in May 2024 and the developed area is expected to be fully open to the public in 2025. In addition to the trailhead, this first phase of work will include 6.5 miles of non-motorized trail.

2024

Master Plan Update

In March 2024, the City of Cheyenne hired AVI PC to complete a targeted update of the Belvoir Ranch Master Plan. The purpose of the Plan is to recognize existing conditions and provide implementation steps to achieve short-term goals at the Ranch.

2008 MASTER PLAN



The City of Cheyenne contracted with Wenk Associates and a team of consultants to complete the Belvoir Ranch Master Plan in 2008. The 2008 Master Plan is a 277-page document that explored a variety of possibilities on the Belvoir Ranch. The document included an extensive review of the history and natural character of the Belvoir Ranch. The improvements explored in the document include trails, a golf courses, interpretive sites, wind energy development, camping sites, reservoirs, a petting zoo, and several other ideas and possibilities. The implementation of the plan was expected to take 15 years and carried a price tag of \$30.9 million dollars. In addition to these improvements, the plan includes a robust discussion on existing conditions and Ranch history.

The most notable improvements that have taken place from the 2008 Master Plan is the development of the wind turbines on the Ranch. There were approximately 100 turbines constructed on the Ranch between 2019 and 2022. Although wind energy development was cited as a possibility in the 2008 Plan, the implementation of their development is more extensive than the original

plan proposed. Other implementation steps from the previous plan include the planning and development of trails, clean-up of the TCE plume, efforts to establish fishing, and the on-going management of wildlife through the Game and Fish Hunter Management Area. Additionally, the Laramie County Conservation District has been actively working on rehabilitating a reservoir on the far southwest corner of the ranch for a fishing opportunity.

Though some progress has been made at the Ranch, the 2008 Plan is noted for its lack of implementation. In speaking with Planning staff and various stakeholders it has been determined that the lack of implementation was due to the variety of options explored without clear implementation steps. Furthermore, access continues to be inhibited by the several rail lines that transect the property. This plan update will reign in these items with implementation steps. Although many items in the 2008 Plan did not come to fruition, the document maintains a rich repository of information on existing conditions and history that this plan update will not explore.

CHAPTER

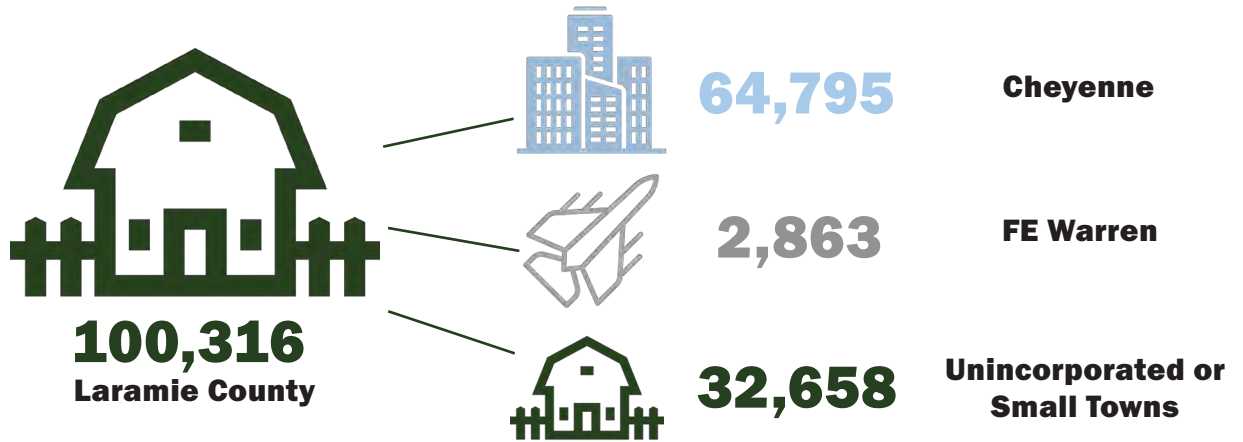
02

Existing Conditions

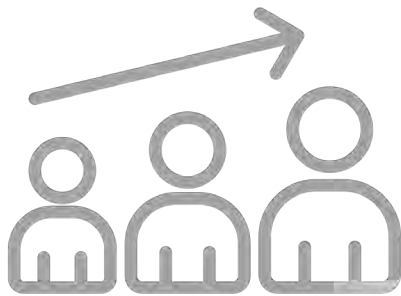


Area

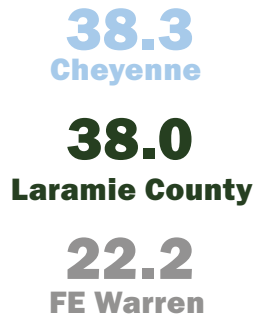
Population



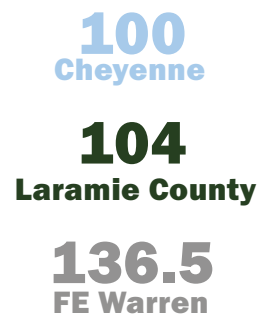
Area Age and Sex



Median Age



Males per 100 Females

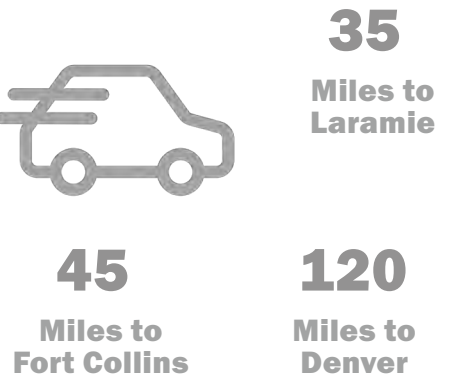
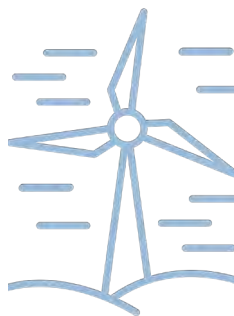


Other Considerations

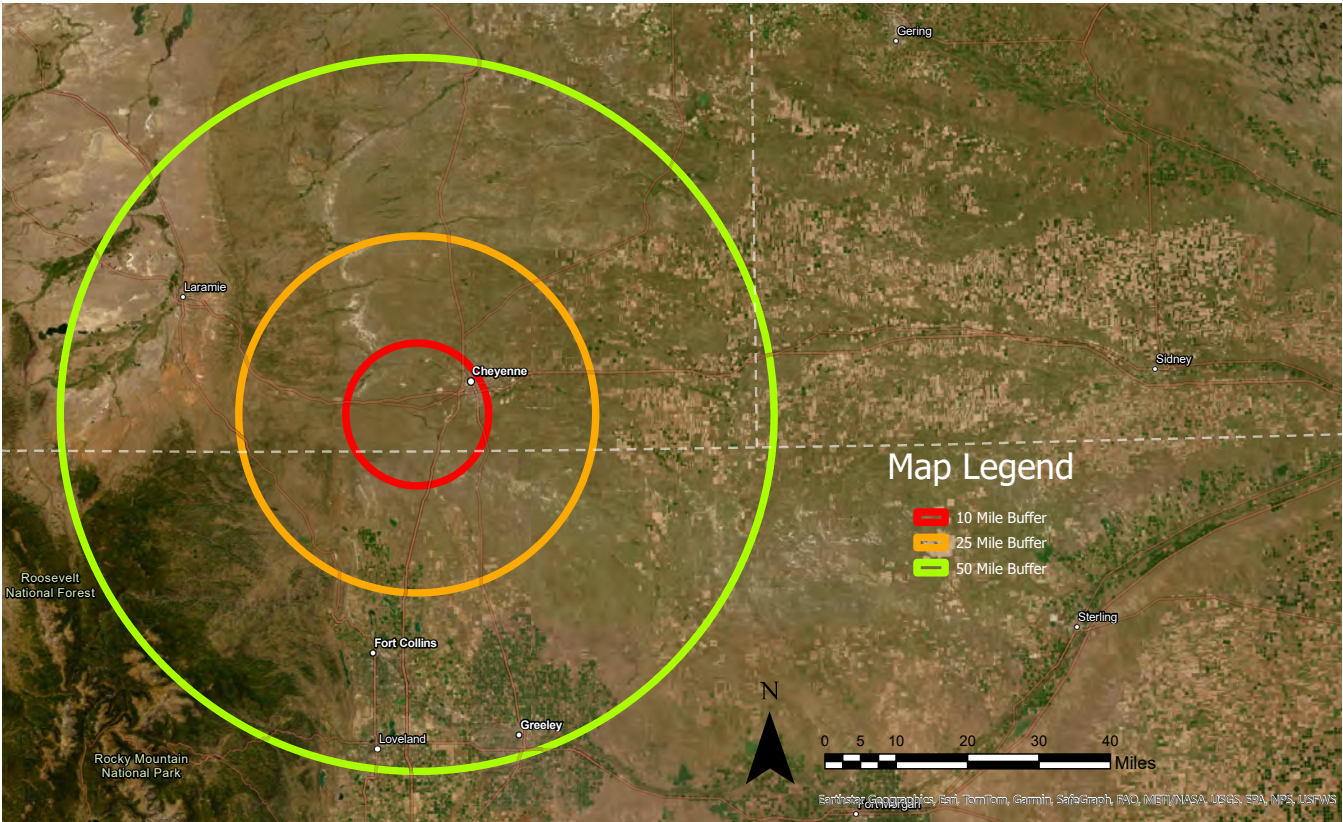


6.5 Miles of Trails in Progress

106 Wind Turbines



The Belvoir Ranch is located eight (8) miles west of Downtown Cheyenne. Due to its close proximity to the City it can be inferred that the majority of users of the Belvoir Ranch will be from the Cheyenne and the surrounding vicinity. In addition to these users, the connection to northern Colorado will surely draw users to the Ranch. The infographic above illustrates the variety of users that can be expected at the Belvoir Ranch and other key demographics about the City of Cheyenne and Laramie County. To provide context to the numbers below, our sources indicate the average age of trail runners is between 22 and 55 with 63.5% being male and 36.5% being female. Furthermore, 75.5% of mountain bikers are between the ages of 30-59. These numbers illustrate the population of Cheyenne and Laramie County is similar to the demographics of trail users.



In addition to the population in close proximity to Laramie County, the Belvoir’s location makes it well suited to be a regional recreation destination. The infographic on the previous page illustrates that the Ranch is 35 miles to Laramie, 45 miles to Fort Collins, and just over 100 miles to Denver. This is further elaborated on by the map above, which shows destinations within a 10-, 25-, and 50-mile radius of the Ranch Headquarters. The proximity coupled with the ability for regional connections shows the Ranch can truly be a recreation destination in southeast Wyoming.

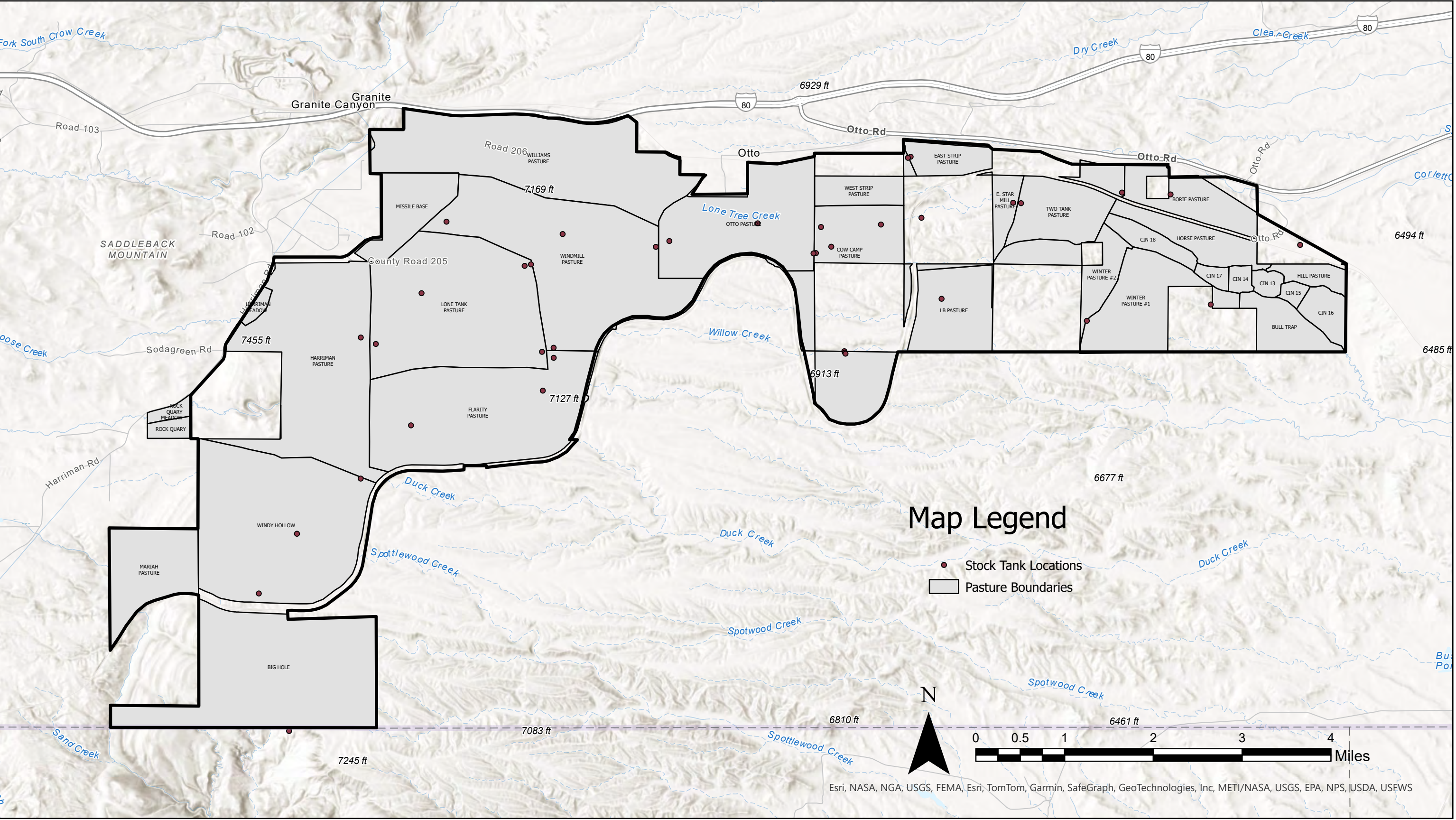
The table to the right shows the population of the adjacent counties in Colorado and some notable communities in close proximity to the Belvoir Ranch. Recreation and tourism is one of the most prominent industries in Colorado, which further increases the likelihood those in northern Colorado may visit the Belvoir Ranch once trails are open.

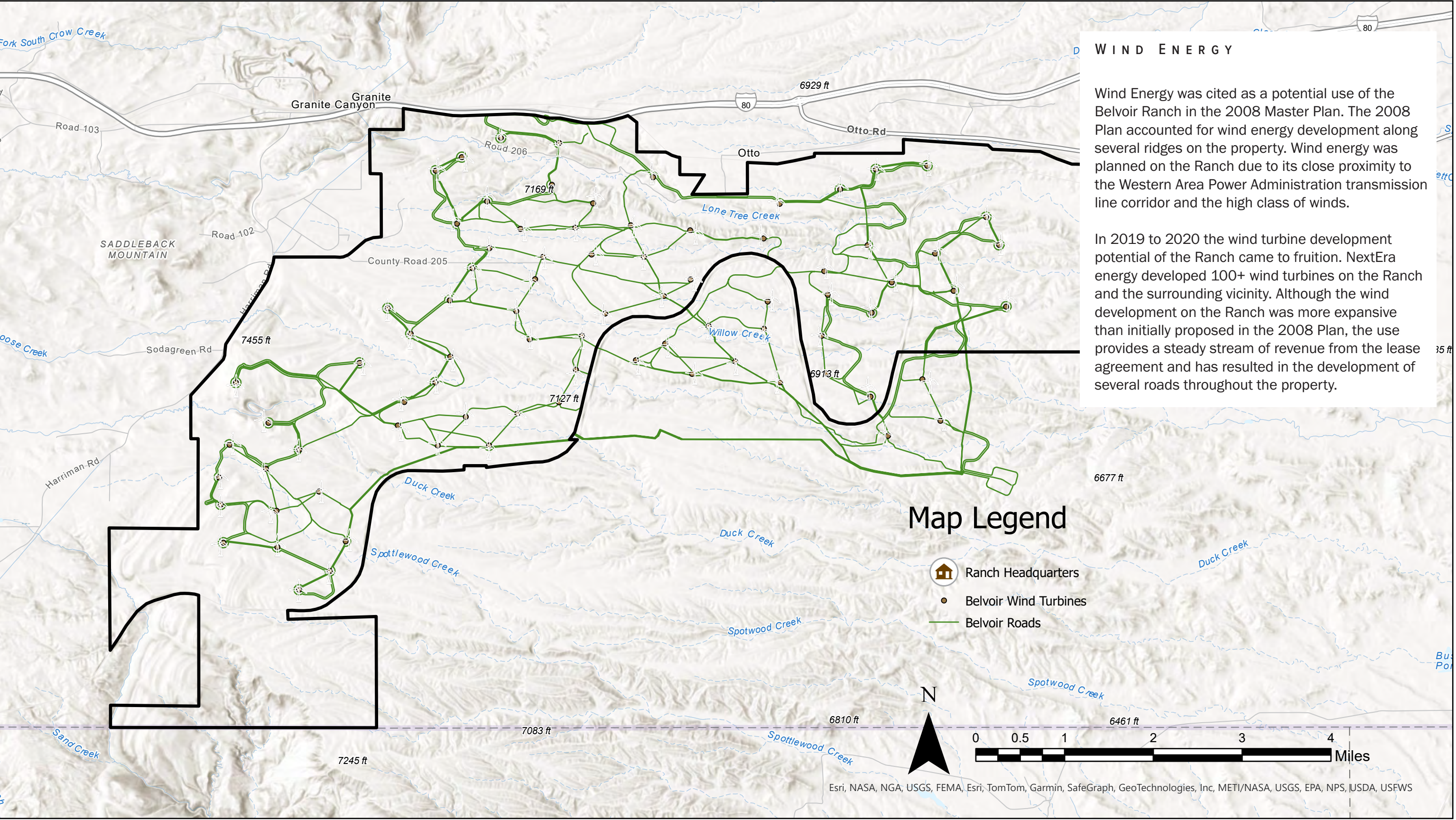
Destination	Population
Larimer County	370,771
Fort Collins	169,810
Loveland	76,378
Wellington	11,047
Timnath	6,487
Weld County	328,981
Greeley	108,795
Windsor	32,716
Severance	7,683
Eaton	5,802

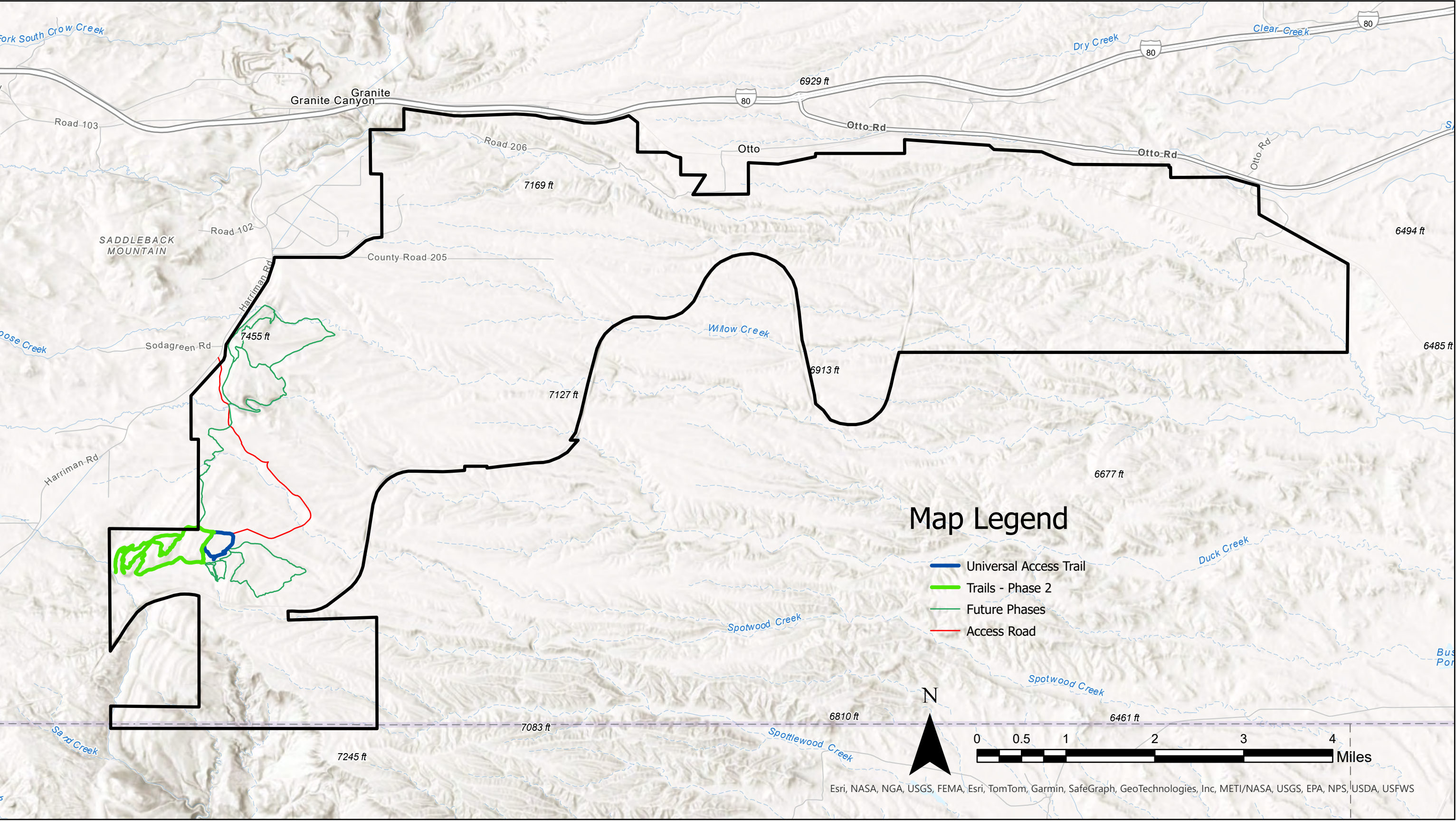
MAP TABLE OF CONTENTS

The following pages overview the Belvoir Maps through a variety of maps. Several inventory maps were not updated from the 2008 Master Plan. This includes the landuse/landcover map found on page 11 of the 2008 Plan; the wildlife habitat maps found from pages 15-16 of the 2008 Plan; the sensitive species map found on page 19 of the 2008 Plan; and the surface geology map found on page 23 of the 2008 Plan. Although these are important elements to acknowledge when crafting a Master Plan, the content of the maps is largely unchanged. The maps that are illustrated in the following pages include:

 A wide-angle photograph of a flat, open landscape under a cloudy sky. Several large wind turbines are visible in the distance, and a small building is on the right.	Pasture Map	15
 A close-up photograph of a single wind turbine against a clear blue sky. The tower and the base of the blades are visible.	Wind Turbines	17
 A group of people are standing on a rocky, elevated trail overlooking a vast, green valley with rolling hills and a small pond in the distance.	Trail Planning	19
 A photograph of a green metal gate across a field. A white sign with red and black text is attached to the gate. The sign reads: 'NO TRESPASSING', 'PROTECTED NATURAL AREA', 'CLOSED PENDING', 'DEVELOPMENT OF USE PLAN, TRAILS, AND SAFETY SUPPORT', and 'Report All Violations - 637-6281'.	Access Points	23
 A photograph of a stone building with a white door. In the foreground, there is a wooden fence and a small green sign that says 'KENNEDY WELL'. A wind turbine is visible in the background.	BOPU Resources	35





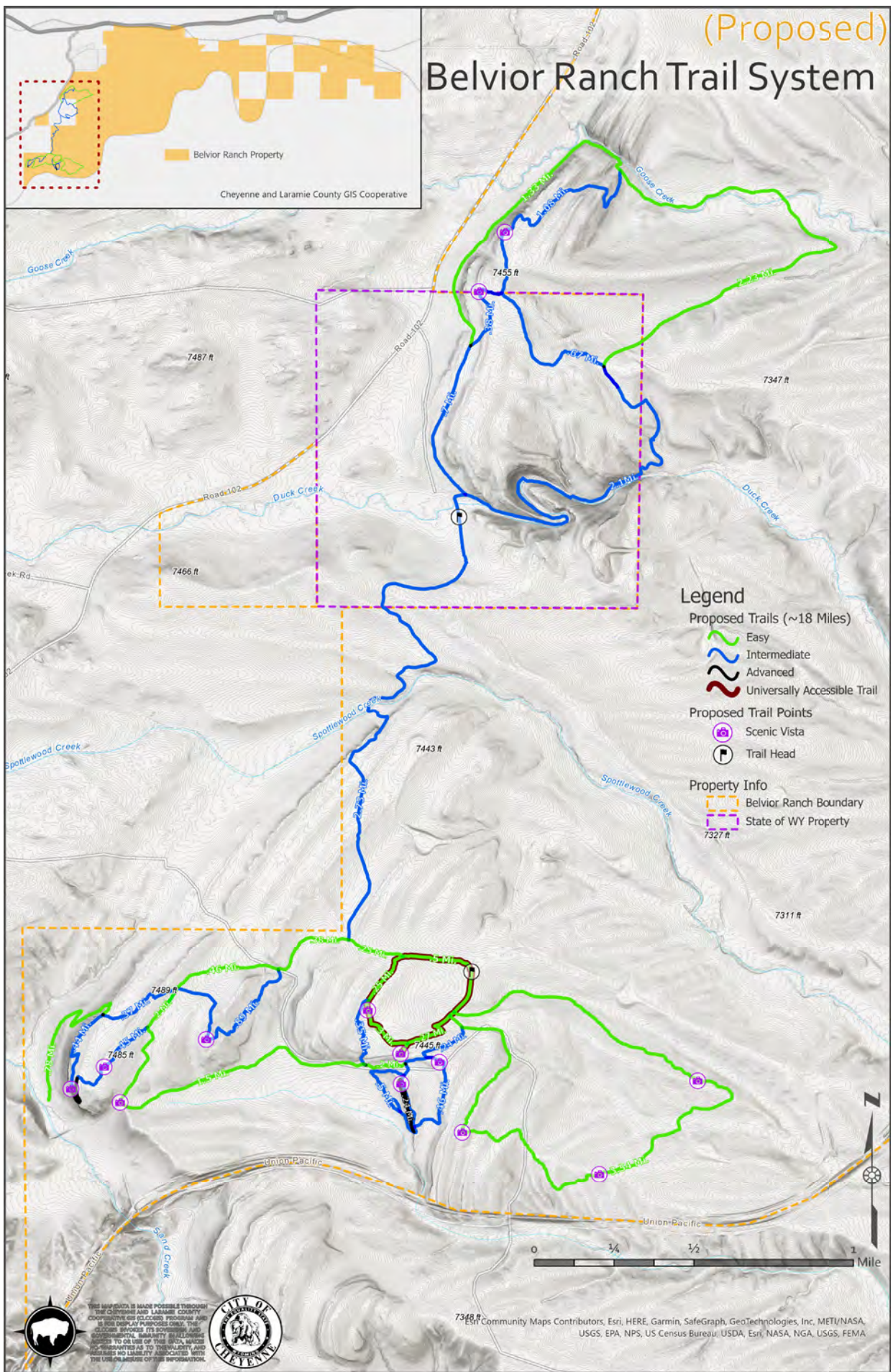


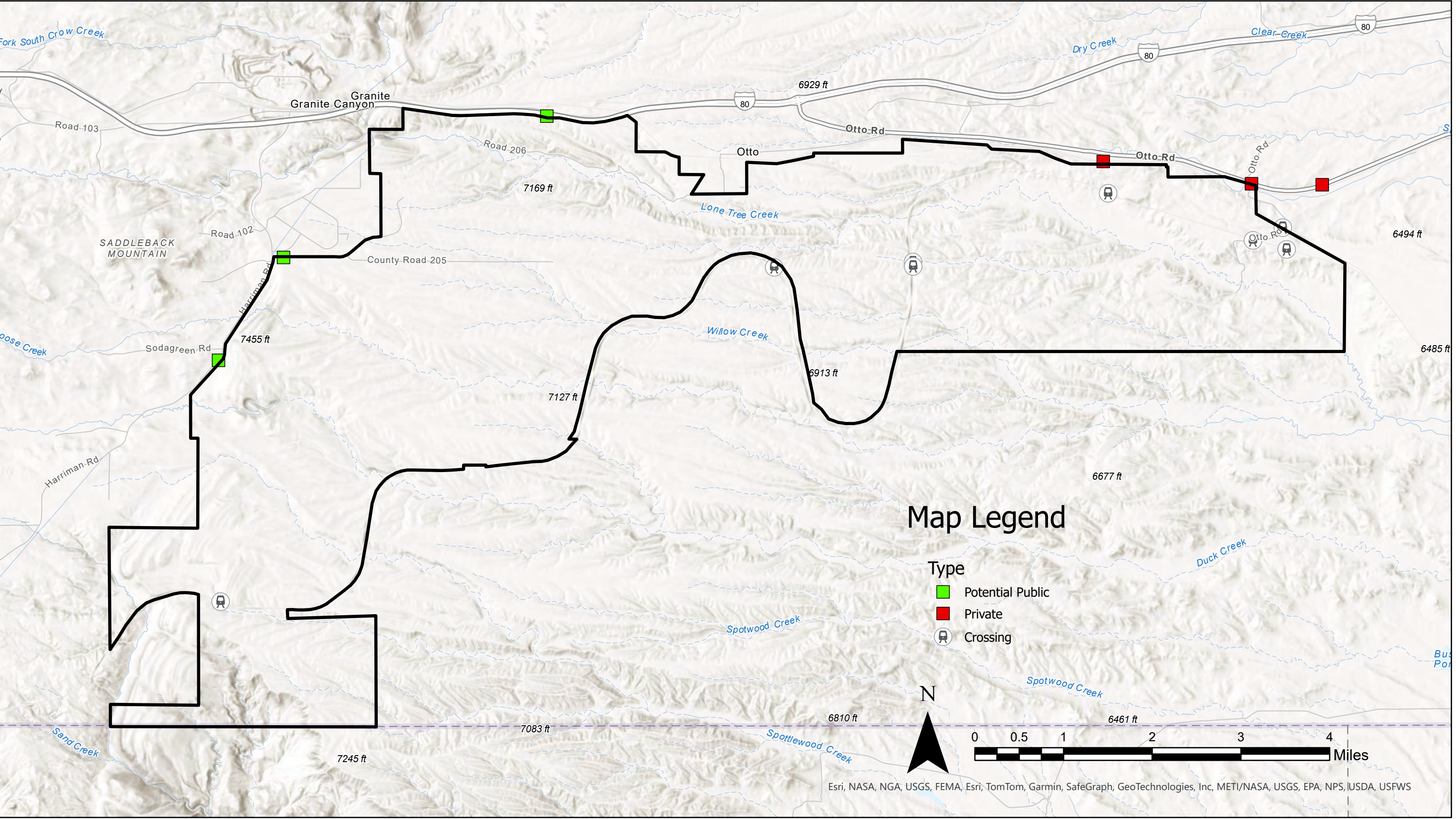
TRAIL DEVELOPMENT

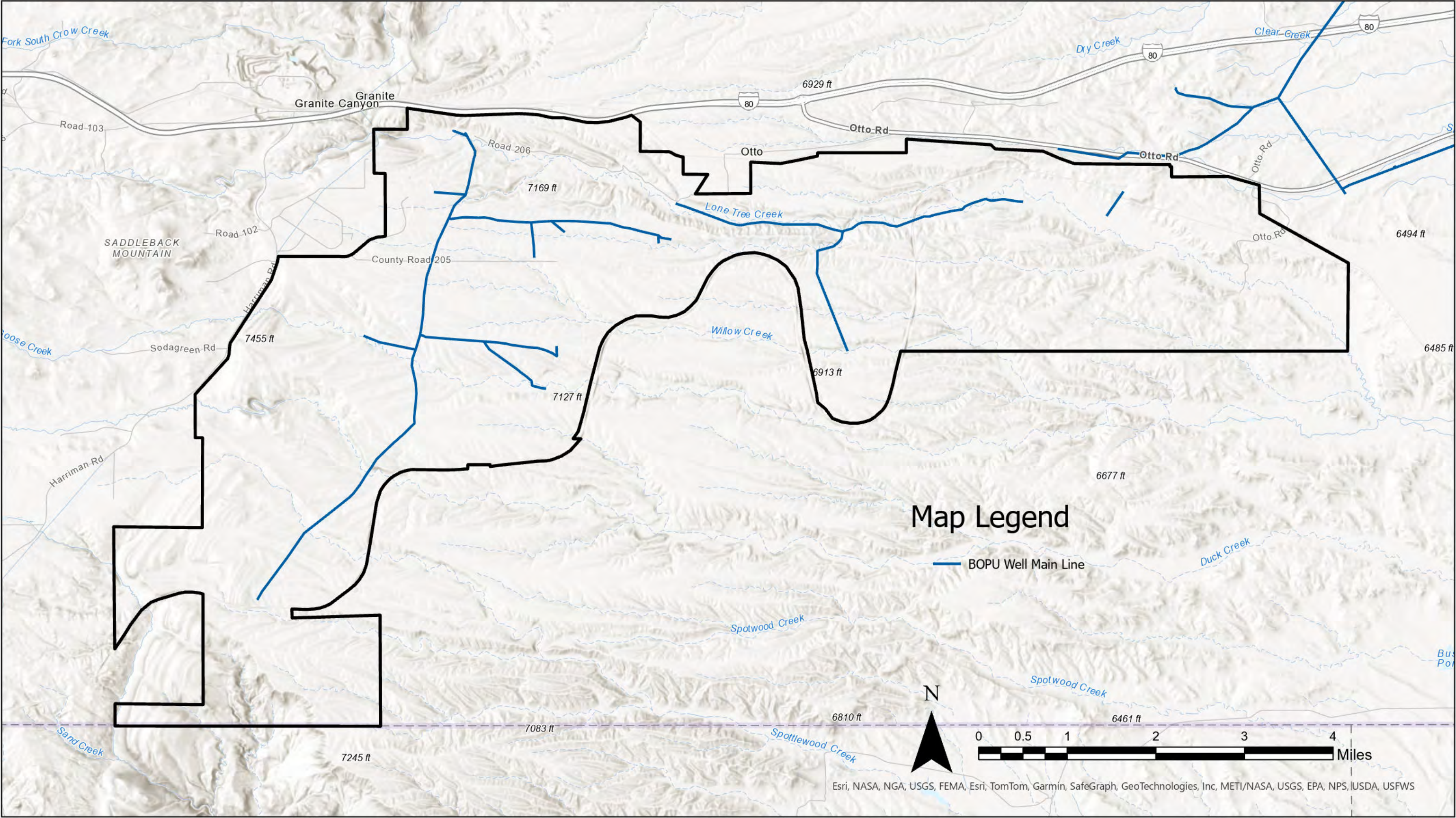
In July 2023 the City of Cheyenne contracted with TPT Trails, LLC, to design a system of non-motorized, natural-surface trails on Belvoir Ranch. The construction of the trails is moving forward with the development of a trailhead and ADA-accessible loop, which was funded by a grant from the State of Wyoming. Additionally the next section of trails will begin construction in the summer of 2024 adding an additional 6.5 miles of trails. The second section of trails will be funded by the wind energy lease. Both sections are anticipated to be open by June of 2025 with opportunities for subsequent sections to be added in the coming years. The first phases of the proposed trail system are highlighted in the map to the right.

The project team visited the Belvoir Ranch on August 1, 2024 to catalogue the progress of the trail construction. The surrounding photographs show the substantial progress of the trails and highlight the natural amenities featured by the trail system.







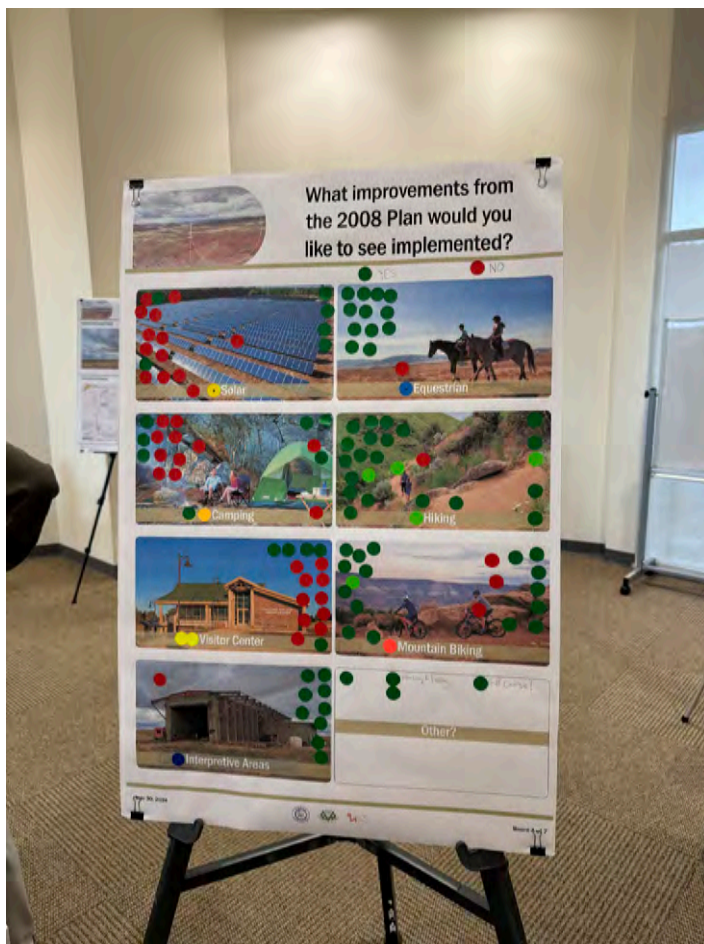


CHAPTER

03

Stakeholder & Public Engagement





The project team determined the best way to go about developing the plan was through public and stakeholder engagement. Not only did this engagement involve public meetings with citizens of Cheyenne and Harriman, but it also involved focus group meetings with the Belvoir Ranch Steering Committee, City Public Works, City Engineering, the Board of Public Utilities, a representative from the Nature Conservancy, Larimer County Open Space, and the City of Fort Collins. It should be noted that contact has been attempted to be made with additional stakeholders groups but no response has been received at the time of the drafting of this plan. Should contact be made, the incorporation of their comments should be made through adopting appendices.

The following pages summarize stakeholder input on a variety of topics (a detailed list of responses can be found in appendix A). The input received was considered in crafting the character areas of the Ranch with their goals and policies. The meeting schedule with stakeholders are as follows (all in 2024):

- » Belvoir Ranch Steering Committee (3/20)
- » Public Meeting #1 (5/30)
- » Public Meeting #2 - Harriman (6/12)
- » City Council Work Session (6/28)
- » Board of Public Utilities (4/23)
- » Public Works (5/6)
- » Ranch Manager (4/17)
- » City Engineer's Office (5/15)
- » Nature Conservancy (5/2)
- » Larimer County Open Space (5/17)
- » City of Fort Collins Open Space (5/28)
- » Cheyenne Running Club (5/14)
- » Overland Mountain Bike Assoc. (10/29)



Relevance to Plan Update

The Belvoir Ranch Steering Committee met on March 20, 2024 for their regular meeting. The committee hold regular meetings to discuss pertinent information regarding the ranch and is made up of a variety of stakeholders. The project team introduced the Belvoir Ranch Master Plan Update to the steering committee and requested preliminary feedback from the committee in the form of a wish list. The complete responses from the Belvoir Ranch Master Plan Update Wish List can be found in Appendix A.

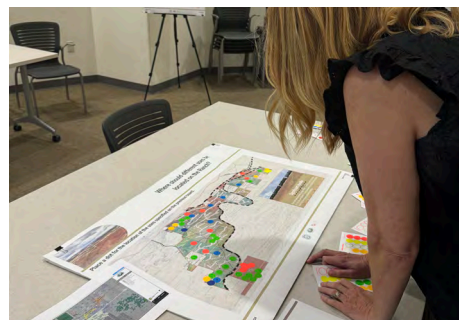
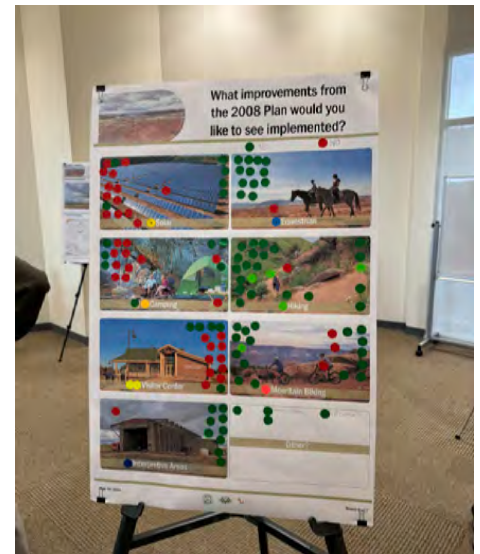
Key Recommendations

- » Recreation uses should be a focus of the Master Plan update
- » The landfill and Board of Public Utilities uses remain relevant
- » There may be an opportunity to consider commercial development
- » Public input is an integral component of the planning process
- » The project team should meet with a variety of stakeholders that are present at the steering committee meetings

Public Meeting 1: May 30, 2024

The first public meeting for the Belvoir Ranch was held on May 30 in the Sunflower Room of the Laramie County Library from 4:00 to 6:30 pm. It is estimated that over 50 citizens attended the meeting with 36 signing-in. The meeting was in an open house format that allowed residents to interact with different boards to share their opinions on uses and locations for improvements. The surrounding pictures show the responses collected and interaction at the meeting. Overall, the feedback from residents focused on:

- » Gaining access, specifically to the Big Hole
- » Separating uses, with specific requests to designate hiking only v biking only v equestrian only trails
- » Focus on the well-being of wildlife
- » Emphasis on recreational uses, a general lack of interest in furthering industrial uses



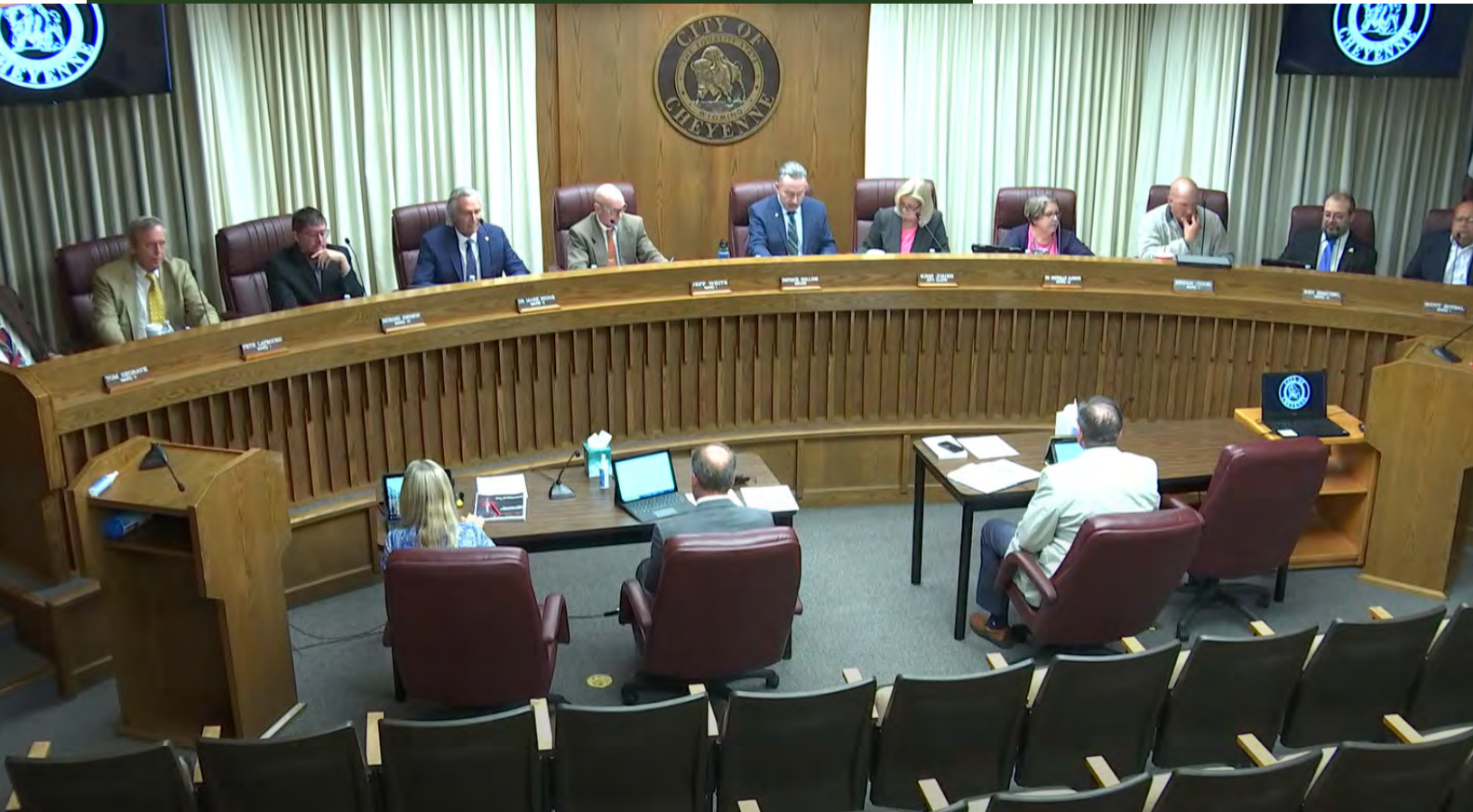
Public Meeting 2: June 12, 2024

The second public meeting for the Belvoir Ranch was held on June 12 at the Harriman Chapel from 6:00 to 7:00 pm. Approximately a dozen residents showed up at the meeting, including members from the volunteer fire department and the sheriff's office. The meeting was in a focus group format that allowed for extensive discussion with the residents. The residents shared the following overarching concerns:

- » Concerns with safety with increased public access
- » An interest in increased law enforcement presence with more users frequenting the area
- » Focus on the well-being of wildlife
- » Lack of interest in energy and industrial development, unhappy with wind farm development
- » Apprehensive about increased traffic on Harriman Road



City Council Work Session



Relevance to Plan Update

The project team held a work session with City Council on June 28. The purpose of the work session was to discuss the public processes and feedback that had been received in the various public meetings. Furthermore, it allowed the team to elaborate on the information gathered from the stakeholders that had been interviewed. Lastly, it provided another avenue to inform the public of the master plan update. Specifically, the agenda followed:

- 2008 Master Plan Overview
- Implementation of Plan
- Objectives of 2024 Plan Update
- Stakeholder Engagement to Date
- Public Meetings to Date
- Council Priorities
- Project Schedule

Key Recommendations

- » Focus on attainable goals
- » Not all recommendations from the 2008 Master Plan remain relevant
- » Council was supportive of the character areas approach to planning
- » Research and understand opportunities for commercial development on the east side of the Ranch
- » There may be a variety of potential energy uses at the Ranch
- » Build in regular updates to the plan once objectives are achieved



Relevance to Plan Update

The Board of Public Utilities is a major stakeholder on the Belvoir Ranch. The Board began looking for additional water in 2002 which led them to cooperate with the City Public Works Department to purchase the Belvoir Ranch in 2003. The staff at the Board of Public Utilities has extensive knowledge on the water resources located on the Ranch including quantities of water, sink locations, the scope and progress on the TCE clean-up and the costs associated with developing the infrastructure to tap into the water resources at the Ranch. The Board maintains an interest in a potential reservoir at the Ranch and will remain a vested stakeholder considering water resources.

Key Recommendations

- » Minimize conflicts between uses on the Ranch
- » TCE remediation is on-going and likely will be for the foreseeable future
- » Keep people away from critical water supply resources
- » Water from the Ranch may be allocated to the CK Gold Mine if the project comes to fruition, which will lead to cost savings in construction. This model may be followed with future development opportunities
- » There had previously been a \$40 Million price tag to develop the water resources at the Ranch, this number has likely increased
- » Maintain water development and buffers
- » Consider corridors for future water development and pipelines



Relevance to Plan Update

Public Works holds a significant stake in the Belvoir Ranch. As previously mentioned, the location of a new land fill was a primary consideration of the purchase of the Ranch. Due to the funding put forth at the time of purchase, the Public Works Department maintains that the location of the future landfill will be required to remain in place. In addition to the landfill, Public Works has interest in the Ranch regarding the grazing operations and the staffing of the Ranch Manager. Furthermore, Public Works may be involved in planning for road maintenance and trash collection at the Ranch as it becomes more publicly accessible. The project team met with Public Works Director Vicki Nemecek and Deputy Director Craig LaVoy to gauge Public Work's perception on the Plan update.

Key Recommendations

- » Maintain Landfill location. The landfill will require a 1/2 mile buffer from surrounding uses
- » The current landfill has a lifespan of 40-55 years
- » The grazing leases generate approximately \$260,000 in revenue per year
- » Public works is interested in maintaining the Hunter Management Area
- » New development on the Ranch should consider privately maintained roads
- » Consider dividing uses with more recreation on the west and more development on the east
- » The former military base and missile silos represent a significant opportunity but have high costs and may have liability concerns

Ranch Manager



Relevance to Plan Update

The Ranch Manager manages the day-to-day operations of the Belvoir Ranch. The current manager is Karl Zunker, who has had experience with the Ranch dating back to before the City made the purchase. Mr. Zunker has extensive knowledge of the property including grazing operations, wind turbine operations, wildlife considerations, and water resources. The Ranch Manager position is an important component of the Ranch to ensure all uses exist as harmoniously as possible moving forward. It is important to note that the key recommendations are the opinions of the participant.

Key Recommendations

- » Maintain cattle grazing as it is an important consideration in mitigating wildfire concerns
- » Remain cognizant of potential conflicts with wildlife
- » Strengths include implementation of trails, teepee rings, and the trapper's cabin
- » Weaknesses include access and the wind turbines
- » Opportunities include potential expansion of hunting and solar energy development
- » Threats include wildlife, conflicts with uses, and transients
- » Overall the 2008 Plan faltered due to east side uses and access



Relevance to Plan Update

The City Engineer has been tasked with securing access to the Big Hole via a crossing of the Union Pacific Railroad. In addition to this access, the Engineering Department has also been tasked with the planning and management of the trail systems that are currently under construction and anticipated to open in June of 2025. The Engineering Department has important information regarding costs associated with crossing the railroad and the processes necessary to achieve this goal. The City Engineer was engaged during the planning process as was the project manager for the trail system.

Key Recommendations

- » Access is the biggest hurdle
- » The new access for the proposed trail system will open up significant recreation
- » Phasing the approach for the plan update will allow for more success
- » The City Engineer provided significant input on the allocation of the funding received from the energy lease held by NextEra. Essentially 1/3 of the approximately \$930,000 generated per year is allocated toward recreation on the Ranch while the rest is allocated to the general fund of the City
- » The access over the Union Pacific line will be difficult. The proposed bridge would be accepted by UP, but costs \$4.5 million. The improved underpass costs \$1 million, but may not be accepted by UP
- » Potential for future recreation grants



Relevance to Plan Update

The Nature Conservancy was integral in the purchase of the Big Hole property on the southwestern end of the Belvoir Ranch. They were also involved in securing a conservation easement and trail easement on the property west of the Big Hole. The Big Hole property connects to the Red Mountain Open Space managed by Larimer County Open Spaces. The conservation easement restricts uses and ensures the properties are held in a natural state for future generations to enjoy. The project team gathered the perspective of the Nature Conservancy from a retired employee, Brent Lathrop, on May 2. The recommendations in the adjacent column reflect Mr. Lathrop's perspectives on the Ranch and are not intended to illustrate the opinions of the Nature Conservancy as a whole.

Key Recommendations

- » The Nature Conservancy attempted to instill a conservation easement on the entirety of the Belvoir property; however, this fell through due to potential desired uses
- » The biggest success of the 2008 Master Plan is the roads from the wind turbines, which should be capitalized on for access
- » Though the roads have been a success, the turbines represent a significant disturbance on the property
- » The 2008 Plan contained a lot of boiler plate language that made it difficult to implement (this should be avoided in the plan update)
- » Any work regarding the Big Hole should have concurrence with Larimer County and the City of Fort Collins due to the Big Hole management plan
- » A non-motorized trail or access from Cheyenne to the Belvoir is a significant opportunity



Relevance to Plan Update

Red Mountain Open Space lies directly south of the Big Hole and is regulated by a conservation easement similar to that of the Big Hole. Furthermore, Red Mountain Open Space, Soapstone Prairie Natural Area, and the Big Hole are jointly managed by a management plan. The connection of Larimer County to the management of the Big Hole is integral, reinforcing the need of Larimer County's perspective on the plan update. Because of this, the project team met with Meegan Flenniken regarding the Belvoir Ranch update on May 17. Ms. Flenniken has significant insights to both properties as she has worked for Larimer County Open Space since they were both placed under conservation easements.

Key Recommendations

- » Consider native plant species when constructing trails and design trails at densities that are cognizant of plant communities
- » Consider use of trails. Red Mountain Open Space only sees 11,000 visitors per year due to its remoteness
- » Plan for patrolling of trails and Ranch
- » Implement different levels of trail maintenance and patrol considering distance from trailhead (Developed, Front Country, Back Country, Primitive)
- » Weed management is critical when planning future trails
- » Trailhead planning is important for road maintenance
- » Consider fish species stocked due to greenback cutthroat trout downstream
- » Ensure uses are compatible with Red Mountain



Relevance to Plan Update

Soapstone Prairie Natural Area is similar to Red Mountain Open Space in its connection to the Belvoir Ranch. The property was purchased at a similar time, is managed by a municipality, and is in close proximity geographically. The property is nearly 20,000 acres and has a variety of uses; including mountain biking trails, hiking trails, equestrian facilities, and grazing leases. The project team met with Fort Collins Natural Areas on May 28 to gain insights from the department on the management of Soapstone. The property recently completed a plan update that was used as inspiration for the Belvoir Ranch Master Plan update.

Key Recommendations

- » Safety and patrol is important, what is the ranger strategy for the Belvoir Ranch
- » Consider wildlife species including the northern leopard frog and the black-footed ferret
- » Work with Soapstone and Red Mountain Open Spaces on a trail numbering system to help with wayfinding
- » Ensure uses are compatible with all three recreation areas
- » Use at Soapstone is low, consider this with investment in facilities and future trails
- » Survey sensitive plant species
- » Reach out to the Wyoming Natural Diversity Database in regard to plant and wildlife species
- » There may be a possibility to look into joint funding of the Union Pacific crossing



Relevance to Plan Update

The Cheyenne Run Club was created to bring together local runners through training, group runs, and activities. One activity the Cheyenne Run Club frequently partakes in is trail running, including trips to Soapstone and Red Mountain Open Space. The Cheyenne Run Club engaged the project team for a meeting as they are interested in volunteering for trail building and trash pick-up. The project team met with the Club informally to gauge their interest in the Ranch and learn how the organization would like to be involved moving forward.

Key Recommendations

- » Biggest interest is in gaining access to Red Mountain Open Space and the Big Hole
- » Interest in participating in trail building and trash collection through an adoption program
- » The City should consider events at the Ranch including trail races
- » It will be important to consider how trails are used regarding hiking/running, equestrian, mountain biking, and motorized uses

Overland Mountain Bike Association



Relevance to Plan Update

Mountain biking is planned to be one of the most prominent recreation uses on the Belvoir Ranch. The Overland Mountain Biking Association holds a regional presence in the mountain biking community and assists with trail building, trail maintenance, trail etiquette, and even trail patrol. The project team met with Kenny Bearden, Executive Director of the Overland Mountain Bike Association, on October 29th to gauge the groups interest in biking at the Belvoir Ranch and gain insights to what is needed for mountain bike trails in a regional perspective.

Key Recommendations

- » Make as much use from natural features as possible in trail building
- » The current stacked loop system is a good approach and will allow for varying levels of difficulty
- » Beginner and intermediate level opportunities are lacking in the region
- » There is still a desire for free ride and flow trail opportunities, meaning the free ride park should be explored in the future
- » Overland is interested in volunteer opportunities. They can provide trail patrol and trail user counts as well as maintenance and trail building
- » There is not a large concern over biking in a place with a variety of uses
- » Planning should consider a connection to Cheyenne



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CHAPTER

04

Character Areas



CHARACTER AREAS



Based on the feedback gathered from the public meetings and stakeholder groups the project team has determined that using a character areas approach to planning for the Ranch will ensure improvements will follow a predictable manner. The character areas are generally delineated on the map on the following page but do not need to follow distinct boundaries. The character areas approach provides a framework for determining goals for each character area and providing policies to achieve each of these goals. The goals and policies are described in this chapter with implementation steps for the policies in the final chapter. Although the character areas are not prescriptive, they do describe the uses that are acceptable within their general boundaries. If a use is not described within the character area section, it should go before the Belvoir Ranch Steering Committee to determine if it is an acceptable use on the property.

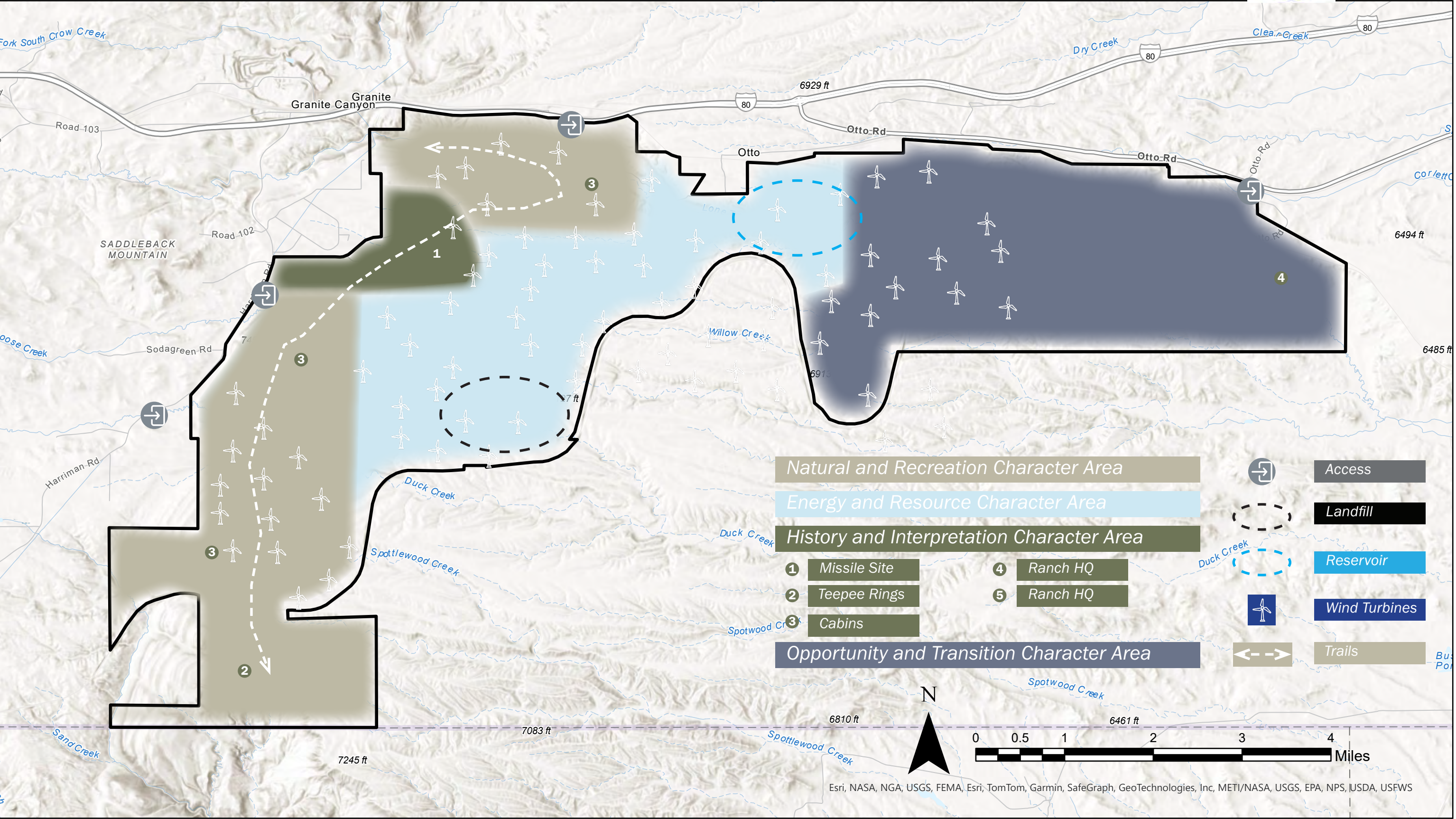
In general, the character areas of the Ranch are described by the following:

Natural and Recreation: This character area builds upon the current trail efforts and emphasizes the connection to the Colorado Open Spaces. Natural and Recreation is generally found on the west side of the property.

Energy and Services: This character area focuses on energy development, water resources, and the future landfill and is found throughout the Ranch.

History and Interpretation: This character area protects the cultural and military history of the Ranch with targeted efforts at interpretation. It is located at targeted areas on the Ranch.

Opportunity and Transition: The final character area is the Opportunity and Transition zone. This is where the Ranch presents opportunity for future development and transitions to the City, found primarily on the east side of the Belvoir.





A. Natural and Recreation

Defining Characteristics

The Natural and Recreation Character Area is defined by the transition from the plains to the mountains. The area is marked by breathtaking vistas and abundant wildlife. The conservation easement of the Big Hole ensure that section of property is preserved with minimal disturbance while the rest of this character area may allow for more intensive recreation uses. The area is expected to maintain a variety of users including cyclists, hikers, runners, fisherman, hunters, horseback riders, and other outdoor enthusiasts. The property to the west of the Big Hole also has a conservation easement on it and a trail easement which could tie trails from the Big Hole through the property.

Notable Assets

- » The Big Hole
- » Lone Tree Creek Hunter Management Area
- » Wildlife
- » Plant communities
- » Developing trail system

Anticipated Uses

- » Hiking
- » Mountain biking
- » Hunter management area
- » Fishing
- » Equestrian
- » Limited camping (primitive)
- » Information exhibits on flora and fauna
- » Grazing (an Energy and Service use allowed in this area for wildfire control)

Strengths

- » Viewsheds
- » Wildlife
- » Plant communities
- » Connection to Colorado
- » Interesting topography

Weaknesses

- » Access
- » Railroad
- » Cellular reception
- » Funding

Opportunities

- » Bridge or underpass
- » Connection and learning from Fort Collins and Larimer County
- » Hiking, mountain biking, and equestrian trail development

Threats

- » Lack of plant inventory
- » Lack of wildlife habitat inventory
- » Conflicts with other uses
- » Railroad
- » Vandalism and improper trail use

Goal 1: Build upon Planned Trails on Belvoir Ranch

- » *Action Step A.1.1: Complete First Phase Trails:* Complete Phase I and Phase II of planned trail system.
- » *Action Step A.1.2: Review Belvoir trails:* Monitor trail usage of Phase I and Phase II to determine if additional trails need to be constructed.
- » *Action Step A.1.3: Management Plan:* Create and solidify management plan of trails for maintenance and expansion.
- » *Action Step A.1.4: New Shared Routes:* Identify alternate trail routes that do not require additional trail construction; such as existing roads and 2-track connections.
- » *Action Step A.1.5: New Equestrian Routes:* Plan and implement equestrian trails off the Warren Interchange access.
- » *Action Step A.1.6: Regional Connection Points:* Identify locations on the ranch most conducive to regional connections and establish the steps necessary to get trails from the existing network to the desired connection points within the Belvoir.

Goal 2: Establish Compatible Recreational Uses Beyond Trails

- » *Action Step A.2.1: Fishing:* Establish walk-in fishing at the Reservoir at Sand Creek. Align fisheries with downstream restoration efforts where applicable. Review other sites for fishing potential. Ensure fisheries do not prevent or delay water resources development.
- » *Action Step A.2.2: Hunting:* Determine duration and use of Hunter Management Area to ensure use does not conflict with other recreation uses.
- » *Action Step A.2.3: Primitive Camping:* Assess opportunities for limited camping. RV camping should not be permitted at this time and camping should be limited to pack-in and pack-out areas.
- » *Action Step A.2.4: Trail Connections:* Identify options to connect non-trail use locations into the trail network.

Goal 3: Celebrate Natural Features

- » *Action Step: A.3.1: Inventory Plants and Wildlife:* Establish new wildlife and plant inventories to inform resource development and recreation development.
- » *Action Step: A.3.2: Access Key Locations:* Establish trails with access to vistas, interesting natural areas, and wildlife viewing areas
- » *Action Step: A.3.3: Limit Disturbance:* Establish trails and recreation uses with minimum topographic disturbance
- » *Action Step: A.3.4: Include Education:* Establish areas for interpretive signage and education on the natural components of the Ranch.
- » *Action Step: A.3.5: Conservation Coordination:* Coordinate with the Nature Conservancy on any development in conservation easements and utilize the relationship to inform options for preservation on appropriate places elsewhere in the Ranch.

Goal 4: Connect Trails Regionally

- » *Action Step A.4.1: Build Relationships:* Work with WYDOT and the Union Pacific Railroad for regional trail connections – railroads limit regional connections on the north, east, and south, while WYDOT highways limit regional connections to the north and east.
- » *Action Step A.4.2: Connect Southward:*
 - » *A.4.2.a:* fully analyze costs and approach to cross Union Pacific Railroad to access Red Mountain and Soapstone open spaces.
 - » *A.4.2.b:* Utilize the trail easement on the property west of the Big Hole to loop trails into the Big Hole and the Belvoir.

Goal 4: Connect Trails Regionally (Continued)

- » *Action Step A.4.3: Connect Northward:*
 - » *A.1.3.a:* Establish framework for connecting trails to Curt Gowdy and Pole Mountain.
 - » *A.1.3.b:* Design and create trail connections.
- » *Action Step A.4.4: Connect to Cheyenne:*
 - » *A.1.4.a:* Identify Steps to connect Belvoir Ranch trail system to Cheyenne City proper.
 - » *A.1.4.b:* Design and create trail connections.
- » *Action Step A.4.5: Review regional usage:* Inventory regional trail visitation and usage to guide trail development at the Belvoir.

Goal 5: Create Guidelines for a Variety of Trail Users

- » *Action Step A.5.1: Coordinate with the South:* Connect with Larimer County and City of Fort Collins to align trail use guidelines to ensure compatibility.
- » *Action Step A.5.2: Separate Trail Types:* Establish zones of use and maintenance considering predicted trail uses.
- » *Action Step A.5.3: Non-motorized Trail Guidelines:* Implement equestrian, mountain bike, and hiking guidelines. Special consideration should be made for the proposed free ride park.
- » *Action Step A.5.4: Motorized Trail Guidelines:* Motorized use will not be permitted at this time.
- » *Action Step A.5.5: Establish Wayfinding:* Create trail name, signage, and wayfinding standards.

Goal 6: Ensure Safe Recreation

- » *Action Step A.6.1: Rangers:* Identify funding for ranger patrol. Determine whether contract patrol can be achieved through Sheriff's Office.
- » *Action Step A.6.2: Emergency Services:* Coordinate Emergency Services with Volunteer Fire Department and Laramie County Sheriff, including communication device coverage.
- » *Action Step A.6.3: Maintenance:* Establish maintenance strategy for trail system and other recreation areas. Utilize contract maintenance and fill in gaps with volunteers or other agencies where applicable.

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B. Energy and Services



Defining Characteristics

The Energy and Services Character Area is defined by the ability of the Ranch to provide energy opportunities and resource uses for the City of Cheyenne. Energy opportunities include the existing wind turbines and opportunities for targeted solar development. Resource uses include opportunities for water development and the future potential for a landfill on-site.

Notable Assets

- » Wind turbine road development
- » Wind energy lease
- » Abundant wind and solar potential due to geography and climate
- » Water resources with strong interaction between surface flow and groundwater recharge (used by BOPU, Ranch, neighboring properties and Dyno Nobel)
- » Large acreages with room for buffers

Strengths

- » Wind classification
- » Complex hydrogeology that separates ground water from surrounding area
- » Solar opportunity
- » Proximity to energy corridors
- » Road development
- » Landfill location

Opportunities

- » Solar development on landfill site
- » Developer funded construction of water and wastewater infrastructure
- » Additional energy users

Anticipated Uses

- » Wind turbines
- » Solar
- » Landfill
- » Water systems development
- » Reservoir (if needed)
- » Grazing
- » Hunter Management Area (a Natural and Recreation use allowed in this area)

Weaknesses

- » Delineation of uses
- » Impact of energy uses
- » Cost of water resources development

Threats

- » Perception of energy uses
- » Conflicts between uses
- » TCE plume
- » Accessibility of landfill site
- » Road maintenance
- » Surface water influence on sinks and recharge to ground water

Goal 1: Reduce Conflicts between Resources and Recreation

- » *Action Step B.1.1: Protect Water:* Protect Board of Public Utilities resources by limiting access to sensitive areas and limiting water usage. Preserve a reservoir location such that the BOPU could utilize that option in the future. Fishing should not be dependent on BOPU resources. Maintain corridors and buffers around water resource options for the future.
- » *Action Step B.1.2: Protect Resources:* Balance energy and resource protection and showcasing nature when developing recreation facilities.
- » *Action Step B.1.3: Inventory Plants and Wildlife:* Establish new wildlife and plant inventories to inform resource development and recreation development .

Goal 2: Identify Additional Energy Uses on the Belvoir

- » *Action Step B.2.1: Identify Energy Uses:* Establish areas where solar, oil, gas, and geothermal are permitted. If areas expand in the future they should establish the process outlined in Chapter 6.
- » *Action Step B.2.2: Establish Energy Use Review Process:* Create guidelines for new energy development and emerging technologies.
- » *Action Step B.2.3: Wildfire Control:* Review new uses for grazing compatibility or alternative wildfire control.

Goal 3: Reserve Landfill Location

- » *Action Step B.3.1: Delineate Landfill Location:* Preserve and acknowledge location for future landfill with a robust boundary to limit encroachments.
- » *Action Step B.3.2 : Determine Timeline for Landfill Relocation.*
- » *Action Step B.3.3: Temporary Landfill Uses:* Assess uses that may be permitted on the future landfill site until the need for the future landfill is realized.
- » *Action Step B.3.4: Plan for funding of Future Landfill with Revenue Generation on the Ranch.*
- » *Action Step B.3.5: Plan and Reserve Access:* Identify the preferred route for accessing the landfill location with appropriate equipment and preserve the route from incompatible development.

Goal 4: Utilize Resource Revenue Efficiently

- » *Action Step B.4.1: Fiscally Conservative Approach:* Belvoir Ranch expenses should not outweigh operational costs.
- » *Action Step B.4.2: Create Lease Framework:* Establish framework for new energy leases as they are proposed on the Ranch.
- » *Action Step B.4.3 : Utilize Alternative Funding:* Strategize matching revenue with grant and tax opportunities to fund a variety of improvements.
- » *Action Step B.4.4: Symbiotic Development:* Promote development such that constructed infrastructure benefits and catalyzes future Ranch improvements.
- » *Action Step B.4.5: Revenue Neutral:* The Belvoir Ranch Should be self-sustaining with limited need for City budgeting. However, this should not deter potential 6th penny considerations.



C. History and Interpretation

Defining Characteristics

The History and Interpretation Character Area is defined by the indigenous resources and military history of the Belvoir Ranch. Although there are opportunities for interpretation of indigenous sites, the City should await consultation from the tribes prior to mapping the resources. The military sites provide a glimpse into the Cold War era and represent a significant period of Cheyenne's history. In addition to these resources, homestead locations scattered throughout the property allow for further exploration of the region's history.

Notable Assets

- » Missile silos
- » Teepee rings
- » Indigenous artifacts
- » Homestead locations
- » Outlaw cabin

Anticipated Uses

- » Interpretive signage
- » Missile silo restoration
- » Parking near historic sites
- » Fencing and boundaries for protected areas
- » Trail connections to historic sites
- » Grazing (an Energy and Service use allowed in this area for wildfire control)
- » Hunter Management Area (a Natural and Recreation use allowed in this area)

Strengths

- » Historic sites
- » Proximity of sites to access points
- » Local knowledge of history on the ranch

Weaknesses

- » State of disrepair in missile sites
- » Conflict of celebrating indigenous sites while preserving their integrity
- » Confirmation of historic narratives on the Ranch

Opportunities

- » Connect with tribes on indigenous resources
- » Connect with FE Warren and Air Force
- » Restore missile silo for interpretation
- » Interpretive signage for indigenous areas and homestead locations

Threats

- » Safety of missile sites
- » Damage, vandalism, and taking of indigenous artifacts
- » Conflict with other character areas
- » Lack of access to cultural sites near Colorado

Goal 1: Preserve Indigenous Artifacts and Sites

- » *Action Step C.1.1 Inventory:* Complete an archaeological and cultural resource inventory of the Belvoir Ranch.
- » *Action Step C.1.2: Tribal Relationships:* Establish a relationship with the tribes that inhabited the Ranch. Ensure they participate in Belvoir development and management.
- » *Action Step C.1.3: Respect sites:* Respect cultural sites with recreation, resource, and private development opportunities.

Goal 2: Identify Strategy for Missile Site Interpretation

- » *Action Step C.2.1: Plan Extent of Rehabilitation:* Create a plan for Missile Site interpretation. Review options for restoration or 'in situ' interpretation. This plan should address which sites will be renovated and the amenities they will contain.
- » *Action Step C.2.2: Collaborate with Air Force:* Partner with FE Warren Air Force Base on site interpretation.
- » *Action Step C.2.3: Identify Funding:* Explore funding opportunities for site rehabilitation. These may include 6th Penny, private funding, or state/federal grants.

Goal 3: Promote Additional Historic Sites

- » *Action Step C.3.1: Identify and Survey:* Identify additional historic sites for interpretation and restoration from archaeological survey and prioritize sites based on access and historic value.
- » *Action Step C.3.2: Cite Sources:* Ensure historic interpretation is accurate based on archives.
- » *Action Step C.3.3: State Coordination:* Establish relationship with State Parks and State Historic Preservation Office to promote sites.
- » *Action Step C.3.4: Access:* Improve access to historic and interpretive sites.



D. Opportunity and Transition

Defining Characteristics

The Opportunity and Transition Character Area represents the ability of the Belvoir Ranch to tie in with the greater Cheyenne community. It recognizes the potential for targeted development on the east side of the Ranch and the ability to connect the Ranch to the City by road and non-motorized connections. Uses proposed on the Ranch in this Character Area should be studied extensively to ensure they are feasible and cohesive with other Character Areas of the Belvoir. Limited History and Interpretation, Energy and Services, and Natural and Recreation uses may be appropriate as interim uses should the area take a longer time to develop.

Notable Assets

- » Vast Acreage
- » Proximity to Cheyenne
- » Undeveloped
- » Interstate connections

Uses

- » Light industry
- » Commercial uses in proximity to the interstate
- » Grazing
- » Energy uses
- » Hunter Management Area (a Natural and Recreation use allowed in this area)
- » Agriculture

Strengths

- » Size of ranch
- » Proximity to Cheyenne
- » Interstate connections
- » City ownership

Weaknesses

- » Perception of uses
- » Current access limitations
- » State Section limitations
- » Feasibility studies needed

Opportunities

- » Connection with Cheyenne LEADs
- » WYDOT collaboration for increased access
- » Developer funded construction of water and wastewater infrastructure
- » State lands collaboration for land uses

Threats

- » Costs of infrastructure development, including access
- » Water and sewer infrastructure is limited
- » TCE plume
- » Wildfire
- » Impact on recreation uses

Goal 1: Prioritize Potential Uses of the Ranch

- » *Action Step D.1.1: Review Feasibility:* Complete feasibility analysis of data center construction on the Belvoir Ranch. Utilities remain a significant hurdle in the near term.
- » *Action Step D.1.2: Energy Options:* Determine future capacity of further energy development on the Ranch.
- » *Action Step D.1.3: Mitigate Conflicts:* Ensure new uses do not conflict with recreation, cultural resources, or Board of Public Utilities facilities.

Goal 2: Identify Locations for Uses

- » *Action Step D.2.1: Industrial Development:* Prioritize the east section of the Ranch for industrial or data center development, noting that utilities will be a significant hurdle.
- » *Action Step D.2.2: Infrastructure:* Ensure new uses can be served by existing infrastructure or have the capability to extend their necessary infrastructure.
- » *Action Step D.2.3: New Use Framework:* Assess barriers and opportunities for new uses. Create a framework for identifying locations for new uses based on impacts.
- » *Action Step D.2.4: Mitigate Topographic Changes:* Assess topography when considering new uses to respect viewsheds and natural environment.
- » *Action Step D.2.5: Grazing:* Maintain grazing lease for revenue and fire prevention.
- » *Action Step D.2.6: Hunting:* Maintain Hunter Management Areas as possible.
- » *Action Step D.2.6: Energy:* Allow for energy development if higher intensity uses are infeasible or impracticable in the short term.
- » *Action Step D.2.6: Trails:* Maintain a trail corridor connection to the network on the rest of the ranch.
- » *Action Step D.2.7: Commercial Development:* Proximity to I-80 makes some locations on ranch plausible commercial centers. These areas should be reviewed for feasibility of commercial development in coordination with the goals of the plan.

Goal 3: Improve Infrastructure for Identified Uses

- » *Action Step D.3.1: Vehicular Access:* Consider an MPO study of potential highway and Interstate connections.
- » *Action Step D.3.2: Non-vehicular Infrastructure:* Pursue developer funded infrastructure and infrastructure maintenance costs when considering new uses noting that all infrastructure will still be owned and operated by the BOPU.

CHAPTER

05

2008 Plan Implementation



2008 PLAN IMPLEMENTATION

One of the primary reasons for the update to the 2008 plan was to determine the if improvements explored in the 2008 Plan were still feasible or desired. This chapter lists the improvements from the 2008 plan, states if they are to be carried forward, and provides a reason for their status.

2008 Plan Improvement	Carried Forward (Yes/No)	Reason
<u>Missile Site</u>		
Monumentation/Signage	Yes	Monument signage for the ranch is an appropriate improvement at the missile site location and can be explored as funding sources become available.
Wayfinding Signage	Yes	Wayfinding signage will be implemented as improvements are made and a funding source is identified.
Gated Entry	Yes	A gated entry is recommended to ensure the public adheres to hours of operation.
Educational Opportunities <i>University Research Center Archaeology, Rangeland Ecology and Management, Agricultural Economics Youth Outdoor Classroom Educational/Interpretive Signage and Trails Education Center Campground Special Events</i>	No	The placement of permanent educational facilities is not recommended at this time. Educational opportunities may be carried out in the field, but not permanent improvements are warranted.
Equestrian / Mtn. Bike Trailhead	No	A trailhead was not a desired use at the Missile Site location on the Ranch
Wildlife Viewing	Yes	Wildlife viewing is accessible throughout the Ranch; however should not be emphasized at the Missile Site location.

2008 Plan Improvement	Carried Forward (Yes/No)	Reason
<u>Belvoir Gateway Village</u>		
Monumentation/Signage	Yes	Monument signage is appropriate at this location as an entrance to the Ranch and should be explored as funding becomes available.
Primary Access into Ranch (Year-Round)	Yes	The Warren and Harriman access points to the Ranch can serve as co-primary access points.
Visitor Center	No	The public input, feedback from staff, and feedback from Council show a visitor's center is not desired.
Cheyenne Legacy & Mtns. to Plains Project Museum	No	The public input, feedback from staff, and feedback from Council show a museum is not desired.
Retreat/Conference Center - Cabins, Weddings/Events	No	The public input, feedback from staff, and feedback from Council show a conference center is not desired.
Village: Gas/Food, Convenience Retail, Specialty Retail Restroom Building, Ranch Maintenance Building	Yes	Staff has determined this use may be appropriate at this location, but should be driven by the market and not actively pursued by the City.
Wayfinding Signage	Yes	Wayfinding signage is appropriate at this location and should be explored as funding is identified and improvements take place.
Interpretive Signage/Cultural History Trail - ADA Access.	No	The ADA trail is planned off the Harriman access point. Public input did not warrant a cultural history trail.
Parking / Equestrian Trailer Parking	Yes	The Warren Interchange was the best identified location for equestrian access.

2008 Plan Improvement	Carried Forward (Yes/No)	Reason
Tent Campground/RV	No	RV camping was determined to not be a desired use for the Belvoir at this time through City Council and public input. Tent camping will be limited, possibly only to the Mariah Pasture.
Campground w/Overlook	No	Camping will be limited, possibly only to the Mariah Pasture.
Hiking / Mtn. Bike / Equestrian Trailhead	Yes	A trailhead is suitable at this location; however, a separation of uses was one of the most cited improvements at the Ranch. Equestrian uses have been determined to be most suited for this location.
Technical Freeride Park	Yes	A technical freeride park is a desired use by the Mountain Biking Community.
Recreation: Picnicking w/shelters, Wildlife/Bird Viewing	Yes	This use is appropriate for this location but will be contingent on future funding opportunities. It is not a priority at this time.
<u>West Reservoir Site</u>		
Frontcountry Reservoir #1 - ADA Accessible	Yes	The Board of Public Utilities has indicated that a reservoir may still be needed in the future and should remain an option on this plan update.
Parking / Bus Parking	Yes	Should the reservoir be warranted in the future, it may have the amenities considered in this 2008 plan.
Tent / Group Camping	No	Camping has been determined to be a limited use at the Belvoir through staff and Council interactions.

2008 Plan Improvement	Carried Forward (Yes/No)	Reason
Hiking / Equestrian Trailhead	Yes	Trailheads may be considered if the reservoir comes to fruition.
Vault Toilet	Yes	Vault toilets are an appropriate use if the reservoir comes to fruition and serves as a recreation site.
Links Golf Course & Clubhouse	No	The feedback received from City Council and the public have not led to a golf course being a desired use at the Belvoir.
Backcountry Reservoir #2	Yes	The Board of Public Utilities has indicated this use may be appropriate but is not warranted at this time.
Activity Areas: Playground, Archery Practice Area, Frisbee Golf	No	This level of active recreation was not desired through public engagement and staff feedback, but may be revisited in the future.
Recreation: Fishing, Swimming, Picnicking w/Shelters, Wildlife/Bird Viewing, Backcountry Camping	Yes	These uses are appropriate if the reservoirs come to fruition; through backcountry camping may not be appropriate.
<u>Belvoir Meadow</u>		
Wayfinding Signage	No	The Belvoir Meadow is not anticipated to be a location for public recreation access and the uses considered in the 2008 Plan are not appropriate for the Opportunity and Transition Zone.
Hiking/Equestrian Trails	No	
Backcountry Hiking/Equestrian Trailhead	No	
Backcountry Camping, Hiking, and Equestrian Tent/Group Camping	No	
Vault Toilets	No	
Ranch Headquarters	Yes	The Ranch Headquarters will remain in place.

2008 Plan Improvement	Carried Forward (Yes/No)	Reason
Equestrian Center/Dude Ranch	No	An Equestrian Center and Dude Ranch is not a desired use at the Belvoir Ranch from public and council feedback.
Educational/Interpretive Signage and Trails Wetlands, Wildlife Viewing, Birding, Historic, Ranching	No	These uses were not desired from the public or council and do not fit in with the Opportunity and Transition Character area.
Backcountry Reservoirs	Yes	This use may be desired by the Board of Public Utilities in the future.
Activity Areas: Playground, Frisbee Golf, Petting Zoo	No	The Belvoir Meadow is not anticipated to be a location for public recreation access and the uses considered in the 2008 Plan are not appropriate for the Opportunity and Transition Zone.
Recreation: Fishing, Swimming, Picnicking with shelters Wildlife/ Bird Viewing. Wagon Riders/ Chuck Wagon Dinners	No	The uses of petting zoo, chuck wagon dinners, and wagon rides are not carried forward at any location.
<u>The Big Hole</u>		
Monumentation/Signage	Yes	Monument signage for the ranch is an appropriate improvement at the Big Hole location and can be explored as funding sources become available.
Wayfinding Signage	Yes	Wayfinding signage will be implemented as improvements are made and a funding source is identified.
Primitive Individual / Group Camping	Yes	The reservoir in the Mariah pasture was identified as a location where primitive camping should be considered
Vault Toilets/ Potable Water	Yes	Vault toilets are being constructed as part of phase one of the trail construction. Potable water should be considered as well.

2008 Plan Improvement	Carried Forward (Yes/No)	Reason
Equestrian Trailer Parking	Yes	Equestrian uses may be considered and implemented at the Big Hole location once the connection to Colorado is made as they are permitted at Red Mountain Open Space.
Hiking/Mountain Biking/ Equestrian Trailhead	Yes	The Big Hole location is expected to be the primary recreation draw for the Belvoir Ranch.
Interpretive Signage/Trail	Yes	There are many artifacts and points of interest identified in this area that may be highlighted as funding becomes available.
Overlook - ADA Accessible	Yes	The Universal Access Trail is being constructed with the first phase of trail construction and may be expanded upon contingent on future funding opportunities.
Wildlife/Bird Viewing	Yes	Wildlife and Bird viewing is accessible throughout the Ranch and should be highlighted at the Big Hole location.
<u>Ranch Management</u>		
Cattle Grazing	Yes	Cattle grazing shall be continued throughout the ranch for wildfire management.
Hunter Management Areas	Yes	The Hunter Management Areas should be maintained as possible with regulations updated to ensure conflicts do not arise with new uses.



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CHAPTER

06

Conclusions and Implementation



CONCLUSIONS

The Character Areas approach to the management of the Belvoir Ranch will minimize conflicts between uses, set community expectations for development, and create a framework to consider new uses and update the plan moving forward. It is expected that this plan will be revisited every five years as conditions on the Ranch continue to evolve. This plan does not extensively explore all options, rather it provides steps individual departments or the City Council should take to enhance the management of the Belvoir. Furthermore, the Plan acknowledges actions already in progress, such as the development of the trails and wind turbines, and expands on how these developments should be considered in the future.

CONSIDERATION OF NEW USES

The Belvoir Ranch Master Plan Update acknowledges a variety of uses that could be considered at the Ranch. However, with innovation and expanding technologies, it should be noted that not all potential uses are cataloged in this document. In considering new uses at the Belvoir Ranch, the Belvoir Ranch Steering Committee should determine if the use is appropriate based on the following considerations:

- » Does the use meet the defining characteristics of any of the Character Areas? If so, which Character Area should the use be located?
- » Does the use conflict with any previously anticipated use on the Ranch? The use should not conflict with the prioritized uses of water resources, the landfill, or recreation.
- » In what ways can the conflict between the proposed use and the priority uses be minimized? If mitigation is not possible or cost-prohibitive, the use is not appropriate for the Belvoir Ranch.
- » What are the ongoing revenue and maintenance costs of the proposed use? If the ongoing costs outweigh the revenue, can these costs be privately funded?
- » What is the duration of the proposed use? Will this impact the duration of other uses?
- » If new land is acquired by the City of Cheyenne for the Ranch, the Steering Committee should assign the land a character area and designate appropriate uses.

IMPLEMENTATION MATRIX

The following pages show the implementation matrix for the action steps of each Character Area Goals. The implementation matrix explores the priority, cost, time frame, and responsible party for each action step. It should be noted that the action step may lead to further implementation based on the findings of a study that is completed or a policy that is created.

Priority: Priority is informed by feedback from the public and stakeholders. The Governing Body sets the final priority based in the information from the input process, their experience with their constituency, and their assessment of feasibility.

Cost: Cost is the estimated cost in both time working on the action step and cash investment. This estimated cost reflects the options available at the time of the writing of the master plan and significant swings could occur based on construction costs, new technologies, donations or other unanticipated changes. Lower-priority items may be implemented earlier due to cost considerations.

Duration: Duration is how far out the proposed action step is anticipated to be. Some action steps may be accelerated based on an unanticipated opportunities, or be extended due to unanticipated obstacles.

Task: Task is the City agency anticipated to have stewardship over the action item. Some action items require collaboration between multiple agencies.

A. Natural and Recreation

Action Step A.1.1: Complete First Phase Trails: Complete Phase I and Phase II of planned trail system.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	City Engineering and 1% will take the lead on the completion on Phase I and II of trail construction. It is anticipated to open in June of 2025.

Action Step A.1.2: Review Belvoir trails: Monitor trail usage of Phase I and Phase II to determine if additional trails need to be constructed.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	3 Years	City Engineering and Planning staff will monitor trail usage through trailhead parking counts and volunteer monitoring. This will inform future trail construction so the system is not over built.

Action Step A.1.3: Management Plan: Create and solidify management plan of trails for maintenance and expansion.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	A management plan for maintenance and expansion of the trails should be considered by City Planning and Engineering.

Action Step A.1.4: New Shared Routes: Identify alternate trail routes that do not require additional trail construction; such as existing roads and 2-track connections.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	3 Years	Planning staff should identify additional trail routes that do not require construction. Careful consideration should be made to reduce conflicts.



A. Natural and Recreation

Action Step A.1.5: New Equestrian Routes: Plan and implement equestrian trails off the Warren Interchange access.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Medium	4 Years	Equestrian access should be planned at the Warren Interchange due to parking availability. This should be a collaborative effort between Planning and Engineering.

Action Step A.1.6: Regional Connection Points: Identify locations on the ranch most conducive to regional connections and establish the steps necessary to get trails from the existing network to the desired connection points within the Belvoir.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	High	5 Years	Regional connections should be identified and may require a planning effort. These include Red Mountain Open Space, Soapstone Prairie Natural Area, Curt Gowdy, Happy Jack, and the City of Cheyenne.

Action Step A.2.1: Fishing: Establish walk-in fishing at the Reservoir at Sand Creek. Align fisheries with downstream restoration efforts where applicable. Review other sites for fishing potential.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Medium	24 Months	The Game and Fish and Conservation District are currently considering the stocking of fish at the reservoir on Sand Creek. Species should align with downstream efforts in Colorado.

Action Step A.2.2: Hunting: Determine duration and use of Hunter Management Area to ensure use does not conflict with other recreation uses.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	City Planning staff should coordinate with the Game and Fish in the next two years to update the Hunter Management Area rules to align with new uses at the Ranch. The HMA should be maintained as much as possible.

A. Natural and Recreation

Action Step A.2.3: Primitive Camping: Assess opportunities for limited camping. RV camping should not be permitted at this time and camping should be limited to pack-in and pack-out areas.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Low	Low	12 Months	City Planning should adopt guidelines for camping at the Belvoir within the next year. Primitive camping was seen as an acceptable use while RV camping and established campgrounds were not desired.

Action Step A.2.4: Trail Connections: Identify options to connect non-trail use locations into the trail network.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	3 years	Planning, Engineering, and GIS staff should comprehensively map amenities on the Belvoir Ranch and integrate trail uses near-by. Careful consideration should be given to fragile resources (i.e. Native artifacts, sinks, etc.)

Action Step A.3.1: Inventory Plants and Wildlife: Establish new wildlife and plant inventories to inform resource development and recreation development.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 months	New wildlife and plant inventories should be completed prior to future trail development. There may be opportunities to partner with Larimer County, the City of Fort Collins, or the University of Wyoming to share resources.

Action Step A.3.2: Access Key Locations: Establish trails with access to vistas, interesting natural areas, and wildlife viewing areas

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	3 years	Future trails should highlight and be considerate of resources identified in new inventories. Planning and GIS should map these within the next 3 years to highlight them on future trail construction.



A. Natural and Recreation

Action Step A.3.3: Limit Disturbance: Establish trails and recreation uses with minimum topographic disturbance

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	3 years	The City should coordinate with adjacent land managers for best practices in trail construction to limit future disturbance.

Action Step A.3.4: Include Education: Establish areas for interpretive signage and education on the natural components of the Ranch.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	5 years	Once the trail system is built and points of interest are identified Engineering and Planning should purchase interpretive signing for the points of interest identified.

Action Step A.3.5: Conservation Coordination: Coordinate with the Nature Conservancy on any development in conservation easements and utilize the relationship to inform options for preservation on appropriate places elsewhere in the Ranch.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	Conservation coordination should occur within 24 months to protect any future areas of the Ranch. This should occur between Planning and the Nature Conservancy.

Action Step A.4.1: Build Relationships: Work with WYDOT and the Union Pacific Railroad for regional trail connections – railroads limit regional connections on the north, east, and south, while WYDOT highways limit regional connections to the north and east.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Medium	5 years	Both agencies will be key collaborators on the regional connections discussed above. The City should establish a working group with each to solve connectivity issues within 5 years. Additional consultants may be needed for this effort.



A. Natural and Recreation

Action Step A.4.2: Connect Southward

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	High	5 years	Solidify plan to connect to Colorado Open Spaces and the Big Hole. This is the most highly desired improvement on the Ranch. Engineering should finalize plan for either bridge or underpass and pursue funding.

Action Step A.4.3: Connect Northward

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Medium	3 years	Connecting Northward includes connecting to Curt Gowdy and the Medicine Bow forest areas. The most effective means of doing so may be through existing gravel roads. Planning should identify a potential network within 3 years.

Action Step A.4.4: Connect to Cheyenne

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Medium	3 years	Planning and Engineering staff should consider drafting a network to connect to Cheyenne. This may be on existing roads, but will require coordination with WyDOT and railroads. A plan should be solidified within 3 years.

Action Step A.4.5: Review regional usage: Inventory regional trail visitation and usage to guide trail development at the Belvoir.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Low	Low	5 years	Planning staff should collect and review regional trail data from Curt Gowdy, Red Mountain, and Soapstone to project and plan for usage at the Belvoir.



A. Natural and Recreation

Action Step A.5.1: Coordinate with the South: Connect with Larimer County and City of Fort Collins to align trail use guidelines to ensure compatibility.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	The City of Cheyenne should align trail usage with Larimer County and Fort Collins prior to making the connection to the Big Hole. These entities already have policies in place the City of Cheyenne can mirror.

Action Step A.5.2: Separate Trail Types: Establish zones of use and maintenance considering predicted trail uses.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	3 years	Work with trail consultant on separation of trail types. Careful consideration should be given to hiking, biking, and equestrian separation and yielding procedures.

Action Step A.5.3: Non-motorized Trail Guidelines: Implement equestrian, mountain bike, and hiking guidelines. Special consideration should be made for the proposed free ride park.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	12 Months	The City Planning Department should create 1-page guidelines for each non-motorized use within 12 months.

Action Step A.5.4: Motorized Trail Guidelines: Motorized use will not be permitted at this time.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Low	Low	3 years	Motorized use will not be permitted at this time. This policy may be revisited every three years to ensure it remains relevant.

A. Natural and Recreation

Action Step A.5.5: Establish Wayfinding: Create trail name, signage, and wayfinding standards.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Medium	12 Months	Wayfinding and signage should be established by City Engineering to coincide with the opening of the trails in June of 2025.

Action Step A.6.1: Rangers: Identify funding for ranger patrol. Determine whether contract patrol Can be achieved through Sheriff's Office.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	High	12 Months	The City Council should determine ranger patrol prior to the trails opening in June of 2025.

Action Step A.6.2: Emergency Services: Coordinate Emergency Services with Volunteer Fire Department and Laramie County Sheriff, including communication device coverage.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	High	12 Months	Emergency services should be investigated for response times, coverage, and other important items prior to the opening of the trails in June of 2025.

Action Step A.6.3: Maintenance: Establish maintenance strategy for trail system and other recreation areas. Utilize contract maintenance and fill in gaps with volunteers or other agencies where applicable.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	Contract trail maintenance has been identified by City Engineering. This should be revisited within the next 24 months by City Council if the Belvoir is to be maintained by a future City department.

B. Energy and Services

Action Step B.1.1: Protect Water: Protect Board of Public Utilities resources by limiting access to sensitive areas and limiting water usage. Preserve a reservoir location such that the BOPU could utilize that option in the future.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	12 Months	Establish guidelines for sensitive areas. The BOPU would like to remove trails from sink locations and should coordinate this effort within the next year with City Engineering.

Action Step B.1.2: Protect Resources: Balance energy and resource protection and showcasing nature when developing recreation facilities.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	12 Months	Determine acceptable levels of resource viewing by the public and potential educational intervention to ensure water resources remain at the highest quality.

Action Step B.1.3: Inventory Plants and Wildlife: Establish new wildlife and plant inventories to inform resource development and recreation development.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	New wildlife and plant inventories should be completed prior to future trail development. There may be opportunities to partner with Larimer County, the City of Fort Collins, or the University of Wyoming to share resources.

Action Step B.2.1: Identify Energy Uses: Establish areas where solar, oil, gas, and geothermal are permitted. If areas expand in the future they should establish the process outlined in Chapter 6.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	Planning staff should map areas where energy extraction or development are acceptable based on the proposed trail networks and other amenities at the Ranch.

B. Energy and Services

Action Step B.2.2: Establish Energy Use Review Process: Create guidelines for new energy development and emerging technologies.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	3 Years	The City Planning Department should create energy use guidelines similar to use guidelines in the Unified Development Code.

Action Step B.2.3: Wildfire Control: Review new uses for grazing compatibility or alternative wildfire control.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	Continuous	Public Works should review new uses as they are proposed and assess their compatibility with grazing. If they are not compatible, alternative wildfire control should be considered.

Action Step B.3.1: Delineate Landfill Location: Preserve and acknowledge location for future landfill with a robust boundary to limit encroachments.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Medium	3 Years	Public Works should revisit the landfill study to solidify the location and buffer required for the landfill. This use of the Ranch should inform all other uses and should not be infringed upon.

Action Step B.3.2 : Determine timeline for landfill relocation.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	24 Months	Public Works should assess the timeline for when the landfill will be needed and inform Planning and Engineering.

B. Energy and Services

Action Step B.3.3: Temporary Landfill Uses: Assess uses that may be permitted on the future landfill site until the need for the future landfill is realized.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	24 Months	Public Works should acknowledge appropriate uses for the landfill site based on permanence and impact on potential landfill operations.

Action Step B.3.4: Plan for funding of future landfill with revenue generation on the Ranch.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	5 Years	Determine how recreation fees or energy lease funds may assist with the development of the landfill when it is needed. Special taxes, such as a future 6th penny, may assist with the funding.

Action Step B.3.5: Plan and Reserve Access: Identify the preferred route for accessing the landfill location with appropriate equipment and preserve the route from incompatible development.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	5 Years	Public Works should identify the route to the landfill and identify the standards it should be built to. The route may be used until the landfill is needed; however, once the landfill is built the road should be reserved for truck traffic.

Action Step B.4.1: Fiscally Conservative Approach: Belvoir Ranch expenses should not outweigh operational costs

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	Continuous	Belvoir uses and improvements should be assessed by all vested departments to ensure fiscal responsibility.

B. Energy and Services

Action Step B.4.2: Create Lease Framework: Establish framework for new energy leases as they are proposed on the Ranch.

Priority: High	Cost: Low	Duration: 24 Months	Task: The City Treasurer and Attorney should create a model template for future energy leases within the next 24 Months to prepare for future opportunities. This template should account for impacts and inflation.
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Action Step B.4.3 : Utilize Alternative Funding: Strategize matching revenue with grant and tax opportunities to fund a variety of improvements.

Priority: Medium	Cost: Low	Duration: 5 Years	Task: The City Grants Administrator should identify grant opportunities that can be matched with tax or other revenue generation to make the most out of funding opportunities.
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Action Step B.4.4: Symbiotic Development: Promote development such that constructed infrastructure benefits and catalyzes future Ranch improvements.

Priority: High	Cost: High	Duration: 5 Years	Task: The Board of Public Utilities and Public Works should coordinate water resources development needs and improvements related to the landfill with private development to pursue privately funded infrastructure.
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Action Step B.4.5: Revenue Neutral: The Belvoir Ranch Should be self-sustaining with limited need for City budgeting. However, this should not deter potential 6th penny considerations.

Priority: Medium	Cost: Low	Duration: 5 Years	Task: City Council should consider uses and fees that allow the Belvoir to be self-sustaining.
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C. History and Interpretation

Action Step C.1.1 Inventory: Complete an archaeological and cultural resource inventory of the Belvoir Ranch.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Medium	24 Months	A cultural resource inventory should be coordinated by the Planning Department within 24 months to ensure trail development and other uses do not infringe upon artifacts.

Action Step C.1.2: Tribal Relationships: Establish a relationship with the tribes that inhabited the Ranch. Ensure they participate in Belvoir development and management.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	Planning staff should coordinate with the University of Wyoming to establish a relationship with the tribes. The consultant team was unable to secure this relationship in the Plan Update process.

Action Step C.1.3: Respect sites: Respect cultural sites with recreation, resource, and private development opportunities.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	The City should balance highlighting cultural site while also protecting their artifacts. The cultural resources inventory will inform this implementation item.

Action Step C.2.1: Plan Extent of Rehabilitation: Create a plan for Missile Site interpretation. Review options for restoration or 'in situ' interpretation. This plan should address which sites will be renovated and the amenities they will contain.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	High	5 Years	City Planning should coordinate with FE Warren and the State Historic Preservation Office for Missile Site interpretation.

C. History and Interpretation

Action Step C.2.2: Collaborate with Air Force: Partner with FE Warren Air Force Base on site interpretation.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	5 Years	Establish a relationship with FE Warren on the sites at the Belvoir to coordinate future interpretation efforts.

Action Step C.2.3: Identify Funding: Explore funding opportunities for site rehabilitation. These may include 6th Penny, private funding, or state/federal grants.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	5 Years	The City Grants administrator and Planning should collaborate and identify a list of funding sources that may be pursued for missile site interpretation and limited rehabilitation.

Action Step C.3.1: Identify and Survey: Identify additional historic sites for interpretation and restoration from archaeological survey and prioritize sites based on access and historic value.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	3 Years	Planning staff should coordinate the cultural resources inventory and determine which sites should be highlighted on the Ranch within 3 years to help with future trail building and featured sites.

Action Step C.3.2: Cite Sources: Ensure historic interpretation is accurate based on archives.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Low	Low	5 Years	Planning staff should verify information on historic accounts on the Ranch for interpretive opportunities.



C. History and Interpretation

Action Step C.3.3: State Coordination: Establish relationship with State Parks and State Historic Preservation Office to promote sites.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	Planning staff should coordinate with state agencies on site interpretation. The City should explore opportunities for the State to take over interpretation efforts.

Action Step C.3.4: Access: Improve access to historic and interpretive sites

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	5 Years	Identify sites and methods for access in the Cultural Resources inventory. Trails should be constructed to highlight identified sites but also be mindful of potential destruction.

D. Opportunity and Transition

Action Step D.1.1: Review Feasibility: Complete feasibility analysis of data center construction on the Belvoir Ranch.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	5+ Years	Preliminary indications have shown that data center construction may not be feasible at this time. The City may hire a consultant to explore this opportunity further.

Action Step D.1.2: Energy Options: Determine future capacity of further energy development on the Ranch.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	24 Months	The City should investigate the future capacity and desire for wind, solar, or other alternative energy at the Ranch. This may be completed with a feasibility study.

Action Step D.1.3: Mitigate Conflicts: Ensure new uses do not conflict with recreation, cultural resources, or Board of Public Utilities facilities.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	12 Months	City Planning should work with GIS to buffer key ranch features to ensure industrial or commercial development does not infringe on other uses.

Action Step D.2.1: Industrial Development: Prioritize the east section of the Ranch for industrial or data center development

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	24 Months	This is a policy decision by the City. The exact extent of industrial development should be outlined within the next 24 months so there are not future conflicts.

D. Opportunity and Transition

Action Step D.2.2: Infrastructure: Ensure new uses can be served by existing infrastructure or have the capability to extend their necessary infrastructure.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	5 Years	New uses should be served by existing facilities or provide their own infrastructure. This provides the City a means to get new infrastructure funded by development.

Action Step D.2.3: New Use Framework: Assess barriers and opportunities for new uses. Create a framework for identifying locations for new uses based on impacts.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	24 Months	The Belvoir Ranch Steering Committee should develop a framework for new uses on the Ranch. This should be based on impacts, infrastructure, and overall benefits to determine if the use is suitable.

Action Step D.2.4: Mitigate Topographic Changes: Assess topography when considering new uses to respect viewsheds and natural environment.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	3 Years	Assess key viewsheds and topographic high points to mitigate new industrial uses. These should be mapped by GIS and Planning within the next 3 years.

Action Step D.2.5: Grazing: Maintain grazing lease for revenue and fire prevention.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Low	Low	24 Months	Public works should maintain the grazing lease as much as possible with new uses for rangeland management and fire prevention.

D. Opportunity and Transition

Action Step D.2.6: Hunting: Maintain Hunter Management Areas as possible.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
High	Low	24 Months	City Planning staff should coordinate with the Game in Fish in the next two years to update the Hunter Management Area rules to align with new uses at the Ranch. The HMA should be maintained as much as possible.

Action Step D.2.7: Energy: Allow for energy development if higher intensity uses are infeasible or impracticable in the short term.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Low	Low	24 Months	Assess short term energy benefits while infrastructure is built out for more intense uses. The City should ensure flexibility in energy leases to accommodate future development.

Action Step D.2.8: Trails: Maintain a trail corridor connection to the network on the rest of the ranch.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	5 Years	Ensure trail connections can be made throughout the Ranch. Trailheads should be located towards the west, but bicycle and pedestrian connections should be available to future development.

Action Step D.2.9: Commercial Development: Proximity to I-80 makes some locations on ranch plausible commercial centers. These areas should be reviewed for feasibility of commercial development in coordination with the goals of the plan.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Low	Low	5 Years	Commercial development may be appropriate at I-80 interchanges. Coordination with County Planning should occur to ensure Future Land Use acknowledges this possibility.

D. Opportunity and Transition

Action Step D.3.1: Vehicular Access: Consider an MPO study of potential highway and Interstate connections.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Medium	5 Years	Future connections should be explored through an MPO study within 5 years. The MPO has extended its boundaries to include the Ranch, setting the framework for a potential study.

Action Step D.3.2: Non-vehicular Infrastructure: Pursue developer funded infrastructure and infrastructure maintenance costs when considering new uses.

Priority:	Cost:	Duration:	Task:
Medium	Low	5 Years	This policy should be explored with all future uses and reassessed when there are opportunities for 6th Penny funding.

